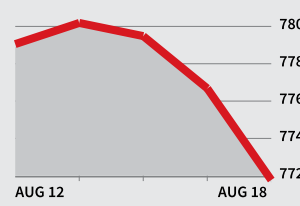


SENSEX 77235.46 (-492.70)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24154.90	-132.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.46	-0.13
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.67	+0.07
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	153463.00	-87
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	233164.00	-2478

TALENT SHIFT.

Share of freshers in IT workforce will rise in the AI age, says Hexaware Chief Executive Officer R Srikrishna **p9**



SUPPLY SURGE.

Prices of lithium are likely to head lower in the second half this year due to a resurgence in supplies **p10**

QUICKLY.

POST AI INCIDENTS
DGCA weighs stricter anti-doping rules



New Delhi: Following recent instances of pilots failing doping tests, India's civil aviation regulator DGCA is considering a new, more stringent Civil Aviation Requirement (CAR) governing testing for psychoactive substances among aviation personnel, sources told *businessline*. A crucial meeting is expected to be held on Wednesday to decide on the modalities. **p12**

CASH IS STILL KING
Cash usage remains strong in India'

Mumbai: Despite the rapid growth of digital payments, cash continues to play a critical role in India's economy, especially in rural- and semi-urban regions among low-income households, senior citizens and small businesses, said RBI Deputy Governor Shrirish Chandra Murmu at the Global Cash Management 2026 conference, organised by Bank Indonesia in Jakarta. **p8**

Tata Sons' AGM adjourned first time ever over quorum

THE IMPASSE. A key shareholder, Sir Ratan Tata Trusts, faces curbs on holding meetings

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Tata Sons 108th Annual General Meeting was adjourned for the first time in the company's history due to a lack of quorum resulting from a regulatory restriction on one of its two key shareholders.

The quorum issue stems from regulatory restrictions on Sir Ratan Tata Trusts (SRTT), one of Tata Sons' two key shareholders.

Under the Tata Sons Articles of Association, the presence of a representative nominated jointly by SRTT and Sir Dorabji Tata Trusts (SDTT) is necessary for an AGM quorum.

In May, the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner barred SRTT from holding meetings.

The AGM was called on Tuesday afternoon to finalise FY26 accounts, declare a dividend and reappoint N Chandrasekaran as a Director retiring by rotation.

While Chandrasekaran can continue as a director till the next AGM, the dividend



HIT BY QUORUM. Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran leaving Bombay House in Mumbai on Tuesday *ANI*

payout of ₹4,474 crore to shareholders is delayed.

VIOLATION CHARGE

The Charity Commissioner's action followed complaints filed by advocate Katyayani Agrawal, alleging violations of the Maharashtra Public Trust Act (MPTA). A second complaint was filed by Venu Srinivasan, a Trustee of Tata Trusts.

The Act limits the number of trustees holding office for life to one fourth of the Trust's total board strength, and complainants argue that SRTT violates this clause.

The Trust denied the charges and sought relief

from the Charity Commissioner to allow it to hold meetings.

NEW DATE FOR AGM

The Tata Sons board will decide the new date for the AGM and that could be linked with the outcome of the Charity Commissioner's probe into the functioning of SRTT, one of the two key shareholders of Tata Sons.

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) is the other key shareholder.

Chandra and board members Saurabh Agrawal and Anita George joined the AGM in person at Bombay House, the Tata Group's

headquarters in South Mumbai. Other board members joined virtually, including Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata, who attended as an individual shareholder, and Mehli Mistry, who is the executor of Ratan Tata's will.

Under the Companies Act, an AGM needs to be held within 15 months of the last such meeting and within six months of the close of the financial year, that is, by September-end.

WAY OUT

"Tata Sons can approach the Registrar of Companies for a three-month extension beyond the end of September if it does not get relief from the Charity Commissioner. If the deadlock persists beyond December, one of its shareholders can seek National Company Law Tribunal directions under Section 97 of the Companies Act. While

Section 97 provides for action against companies that default in holding AGMs, the provision can be relied upon, given the extraordinary circumstances," said Harsh Kumar, Founding Partner of Kaizen Law.

Small/mid-size firms lag as India Inc nears DPDP implementation phase

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Corporate India's level of preparedness for Digital Personal Data Protection Rules (DPDP) remains uneven as it gets closer to the deadline with small- and medium-size entities stuck at understanding the ways they collect personal data and how it flows across their entity.

With 9 months to go for the May 2027 deadline, large companies seem better positioned, given their resources and experience with overseas clients, but smaller businesses are still evaluating requirements, consultants and tech providers working on DPDP, they told *businessline*.

Further, as consent managers need to register by November 2026, organisations wanting to work with such intermediaries must get their consent platform in place by then.

This comes at a time when government sources have stressed that there is "no chance of an extension of the deadline," as companies have gone through sufficient rounds of consultations.

However, MeitY itself has not yet set up a key adjudicating body — the Data Protection Board (DPB). "Work is



Government sources said that the deadline for DPDP implementation won't change

on, applications have been called to staff the DPB, and it will be completed soon," a government official said.

PROCESSING PACT

Experts note that besides the consent framework, the Data Processing Agreement and other process should also be ideally in place by November to allow six-seven months for testing. However, this is turning out to be aspirational, given the current progress.

Kalindhi Bhatia, Partner at BTG Advaya, said smaller businesses are moving more cautiously because compliance involves substantial investment in processes and systems. Some companies appear to be taking a wait-and-watch approach in the expectation of an extension, she said. Larger companies and MNCs are considerably more prepared, she added.

Mayuran Palanisamy, Partner, Deloitte India, said financial services companies are among the most well-prepared, with private banks having begun the journey earlier. Other large companies are now between operational implementation and technology implementation, he said.

"SMEs... I don't think many of them have really started the journey; they have just identified some basic risks and gaps," he added.

Malcolm Gomes, Chief Operating Officer at Idfy, said that SMEs and start-ups had limited resources for dedicated privacy teams and depend heavily on third-party SaaS platforms for their operations. As a result the third-party data flows makes things complicated, he noted.

Experts stressed that the DPB's absence is not a reason to wait for companies, but it would have been ideal to have the Board running by now.

The DPB will be important because, beyond enforcing the law, it is expected to provide guidance on how companies should implement several provisions, said Bhatia.

With inputs from Rohan Das

EV ecosystem charging up in UP, Karnataka, Telangana

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The electric vehicle ecosystem is rapidly broadening beyond its traditional urban hubs, with Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Telangana emerging as major centres of power consumption at public charging stations (PCS).

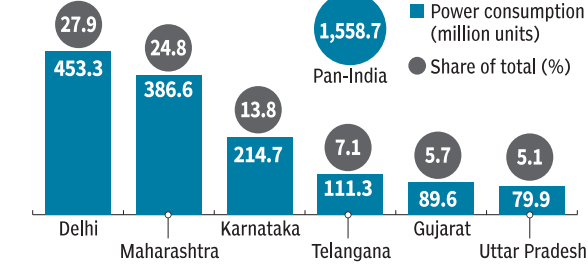
Latest data from the Central Electricity Authority show that power consumption by EV PCS across India rose to 1,558.69 million units (MU) in FY26, more than three times the 465.85 MU recorded in FY24.

While Delhi and Maharashtra continue to account for a significant share, demand in Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Telangana has increased rapidly.

UP's SHARE

Uttar Pradesh is the biggest surprise entrant. Its share of pan-India electricity con-

Powering up



Source: Central Electricity Authority (CEA)

sumption by EV charging stations was below 1 per cent before FY24 but rose to 5.12 per cent in FY26.

Akshay Shekhar, CEO of EV charging station start-up Kazam Energy, said the State's growth is likely due to a combination of e-rickshaw and electric three-wheeler penetration, NCR spillover, highway and inter-city charging, logistics movement and the formalisation of charging loads under discom-connected PCS categories.

Karnataka's rise is strongly aligned with both existing charger density and fresh PM E-DRIVE momentum. It has India's largest installed charging base. A similar story is playing out in Telangana. These States also have a more mature EV ecosystem with higher presence of EV start-ups, OEMs, fleet & charging operators, and digitally enabled consumers, he noted.

Delhi's declining share of national EV charging con-

sumption does not indicate a contraction in the capital's EV ecosystem; rather, it reflects the rapid broad-basing of EV adoption across the country. While Delhi's charging consumption has continued to rise — from 203.1 MU in FY24 to 453.3 MU in FY26 — other States have expanded faster.

In effect, Delhi is not losing its EV lead so much as the rest of India is catching up.

EV TRANSITION

Kazam's founder said he expects electricity consumption by PCS to continue rising sharply and potentially cross 2,500-3,000 MU in FY27, depending on the pace at which sanctioned chargers become operational and commercial fleets shift to EVs. The trend points to the next phase of India's EV transition being increasingly about energy infrastructure rather than merely vehicle sales.

Transshipment to export: Vizhinjam charts new path

First consignment of 7 tonnes of local flavours, including banana & jackfruit chips, heads to Spain

V Sajeev Kumar
Avinash Nair
Kochi/ Ahmedabad

Crispy banana and jackfruit chips are opening a giant new trade door for Kerala.

Marking a formal transition from a transshipment hub to a commercial gateway, the Vizhinjam International Seaport on Tuesday began full-fledged export-import (exim) operations, positioning the State firmly on the global logistics map.

The inaugural export container from Vizhinjam port carried approximately 7 tonnes of value-added food products, including banana chips, jackfruit chips, and GI-tagged Marayur jagery.

Thiruvananthapuram-based Nilamel Exports shipped the consignment to Valencia Port in Spain, with Spain-based Kerala Stores acting as the importer. The products are slated



NEW GATEWAY. A container with export cargo being loaded at the Vizhinjam International Sea Port *NIRMAL HARINDRAN*

for distribution across Spain and Portugal, according to Suresh Mathew, Managing Director and CEO of Nilamel Exports.

Centuries after the historic Spice Route made the world chase Kerala's condiments, Vizhinjam's new shipping lanes prove that the global appetite for the State's unique flavours hasn't changed — only the scale has evolved.

Chief Minister VD Satheesan flagged off the export containers to mark the

launch of the full operations. He also unveiled the State government's ambitious Mission Samudra, an initiative aimed at harnessing Kerala's maritime economic potential.

Satheesan said the commencement of exim cargo operations opened a new gateway for Kerala's development and global trade. Exim operations began at the port 20 months after the commencement of commercial operations.

Vizhinjam, he said, is the

first port in the country to deploy an automated, algorithm-driven system with artificial intelligence.

DIRECT ROUTE

During the launch, Ashwani Gupta, CEO, Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ), said Vizhinjam's transition to exim operations would provide exporters and importers in Kerala with a more direct route to international markets.

"Vizhinjam is not opening its gates to exim cargo; it is opening a new gateway between India and the world," he stressed.

Once supported by full road and rail connectivity, Vizhinjam can emerge as a strategic gateway for Kerala and the wider South Indian region, Gupta said.

APSEZ has already invested more than ₹7,700 crore in Vizhinjam and has committed an additional ₹16,000 crore for Phase II.

BLOOM BOOM



ONAM RUSH. A vendor grades flowers in Palakkad on Tuesday. With the Onam season on, demand has surged, and large quantities have arrived from Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. However, climate change and a shift in cropping patterns have affected production. Despite the increased arrivals, prices remain high, with most varieties costing ₹50 a kg more than last year *K K MUSTAFAH*

Airtel, Jio plan rejig may lead to users paying more despite no formal tariff hike by telcos

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

If you are an Airtel or a Jio subscriber, your monthly mobile bill could soon be higher, thanks to recent plan revisions that experts describe as de facto tariff increases. Sidestepping a formal tariff hike, the country's two largest telecom operators adopted different strategies to balance monetisation and subscriber growth.

Airtel has withdrawn four lower-priced prepaid plans, including the popular ₹299 and ₹319 packs, nudging users towards the ₹349 and ₹379 plans. Jio retained its ₹299 base plan but introduced a ₹300 Prime membership that offers a year-long tariff guarantee.

Assuming subscribers migrate to the revised offerings, Airtel users could face an effective price increase of 17-

19 per cent, while Jio subscribers may see a 7-8 per cent rise, according to telecom expert Parag Kar.

"With Jio announcing the ₹300 Prime membership, it is almost certain that a tariff hike will follow within the next two to four months. The inflection point for customer benefit is at six months, after which customers lose out if a tariff hike does not take place," said Kar.

Airtel's straightforward approach of removing popular plans while retaining its base packages of ₹199 and ₹219 delivers an immediate payoff in the form of an increase in wireless ARPU of ₹16-19 per month and an EBITDA impact of 6-8 per cent, according to Goldman Sachs research.

While many speculate that these indirect moves are linked to Jio's upcoming IPO, brokerages such as Motilal Oswal Financial Services maintain that a broader



REVISED OFFERINGS

- Airtel users could face an effective price increase of 17-19%
- Jio subscribers may see a 7-8% rise

tariff revision is inevitable by the end of the year.

Telcos have consistently flagged low ARPUs. According to Mahesh Uppal, Director at CommFirst India, companies require larger investments to adopt newer technologies. However, increasing tariffs beyond a certain point could prove counterproductive.

"If demand is affected by a price rise, you have to lower

prices. Traffic lost today cannot be regained tomorrow. Demand for telecom services is inelastic only up to a point. Companies understand this," said Uppal.

For now, the experimentation offers insights into how customers respond to different pricing strategies, said Sumeysh Srivastava, Partner at The Quantum Hub.

SPACE FOR VODA

Amid all this, Vodafone Idea's role remains largely in the background.

"For Vi, these moves create some tactical space. Competitive pricing could help it consolidate gains, but with ARPU still below that of its peers and significant network investment requirements, Vi will need to improve monetisation. The sector may, therefore, see operators pursuing different pricing strategies in the near term, rather than moving in lockstep," said Srivastava.

QUICKLY.

FSSAI notice: Dabur India, others rectify mistakes



New Delhi: Food regulator FSSAI on Tuesday said that six companies — Dabur India, Ferns N Petals, Lotte India Corporation, Eat Better Ventures, SS Product Prop, and Om Sai Healthcare — have rectified their mistakes following the notices issued against them for misleading labels, claims and advertisements. “Measures range from withdrawing misleading label claims to revising product packaging,” it said.

Jubilant Ingrevia to buy stake in Zettaone Tech

New Delhi: Specialty chemicals and contract development and manufacturing organisation Jubilant Ingrevia Ltd on Tuesday said it will acquire a 40 per cent stake in Zettaone Technologies for ₹189.2 crore. The acquisition, expected in two tranches, will allow the firm to capitalise on its CDMO capabilities, it said.

ReNew's net profit rises 16% to ₹595 crore in Q1



New Delhi: ReNew Energy Global Plc (ReNew) has posted a 16 per cent y-o-y rise in its net profit to ₹595.3 crore in Q1. Total income came in at ₹4,786.4 crore. Revenue from the sale of power was ₹2,674.9 crore while external sales of its solar module and cell manufacturing brought in ₹1,677.7 crore.

Crompton eyes doubling of revenue to ₹15,000 cr by FY31

FOCUS AREAS. Premiumisation of current portfolio, new-age sectors

Amit Vijay Mohile
Maresh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals is charting its next phase of growth, targeting a near doubling of revenue to ₹15,000 crore by FY31. The company expects its existing businesses, including fans, pumps, lighting, water heaters, air coolers and kitchen appliances to bring in ₹12,000 crore. New growth engines such as solar pumps, rooftop solar, wires and the newly launched super-premium platform, Rhion, are expected to fill the gap.

LURING THE NEXT-GEN “We have a great brand and a strong distribution network, but the consumer is changing rapidly,” said Prommeet

“We have a great brand and a strong distribution network, but the consumer is changing rapidly

PROMMEET GHOSH
MD and CEO



Ghosh, MD and CEO, Crompton Consumer Electricals. “Our task is to strengthen the connection with the next generation of consumers while increasing premiumisation.” Crompton Rhion, developed for consumers seeking technology, design and sustainability-driven solutions, aligns with it. Future development will focus on three themes:

Smart and connected technologies, design-led innovation, and energy efficiency. Crompton sees opportunities in premium fans, connected products and broader cooling solutions. Similar initiatives are underway in pumps and lighting. Meanwhile, Crompton’s addressable market has nearly doubled to roughly ₹1.6 lakh crore through its entry into solar pumps,

rooftop solar and wires. The company is also undertaking a go-to-market transformation to drive sales across its 2.7 lakh retail outlets.

BIG PLANS Butterfly remains central to Crompton’s plans. Having turned around the business, the company now aims to transform Butterfly into a pan-India kitchen appliances brand. Rhion is expected to play a broader role as an innovation platform. Its first launch is a category-first water-purification solution targeting India’s ₹5,565 crore water-purifier market. Crompton is also planning an annual maintenance and expansion capex of around ₹150 crore, apart from a proposed ₹350 crore greenfield manufacturing project focused initially on fans and integrated warehousing.

Wipro Consumer Care in a buying spree, takes 60% stake in Dermatouch for ₹387 cr

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Wipro Consumer Care is joining India’s beauty acquisition race, betting ₹387.5 crore on Ahmedabad-based skincare brand Dermatouch in its 18th acquisition. The company will initially acquire 60 per cent of Dermatouch and pick up the remaining stake over the next three years, with the final tranche linked to the brand’s performance, Kumar Chander, CEO, Wipro Consumer Care & Lighting, and MD, Wipro Enterprises, said. The deal is Wipro Con-

sumer Care’s third acquisition this year. Dermatouch clocked revenue of ₹131 crore in FY26, growing 114 per cent over FY25. Its net loss widened to ₹6.2 crore in FY25, per market intelligence platform Tracxn.

GROWTH OPPORTUNITY Chander said Wipro is “not a vanity buyer”, with valuation, strategic fit, and the ability to add value determining its acquisition choices. “If somebody else has figured that out, and it’s better to take that and grow with it, that’s also an opportunity to grow.”

It’s the firm’s third deal this year as it looks to build scale in one of India’s hottest FMCG segments

The acquisition also gives Wipro access to a digital-first brand. “Building digital brands is not our strength,” Chander said, adding that Wipro relies on founders for that expertise while bringing its own understanding of offline channels and consumers. The company, however, does not believe it is

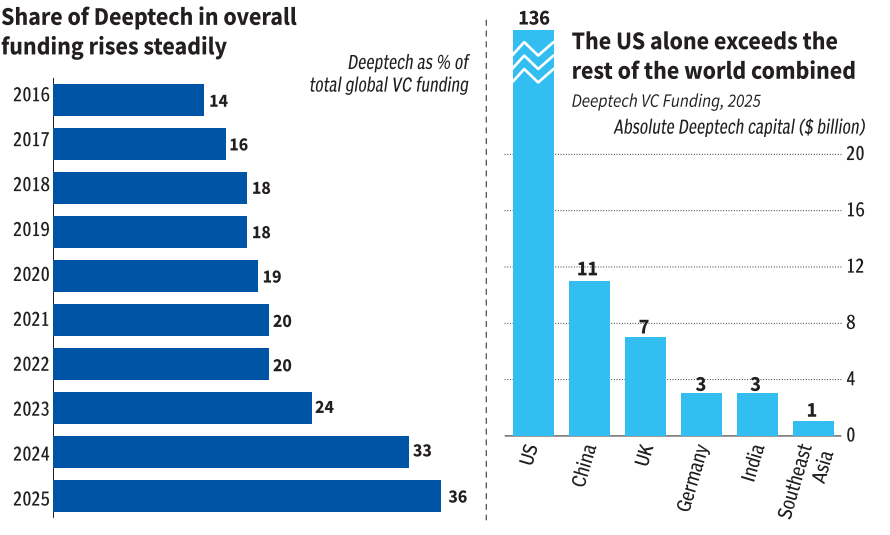
late to the beauty party. “If we just have one right bet, we can be ahead of every other party,” said Chander. Wipro’s move comes amid a broader acquisition rush in India’s beauty and personal care market. In the recent past, Hindustan Unilever acquired Minimalist for ₹2,706 crore, while Marico picked up a majority stake in Plix for ₹380 crore. Emami also acquired The Man Company for ₹272 crore. More recently, Dabur invested ₹60 crore in RAS Beauty, L’Oréal acquired a majority stake in Innovist while Estée Lauder announced plans to buy 51 per cent of Forest Essentials.

VISUALLY.

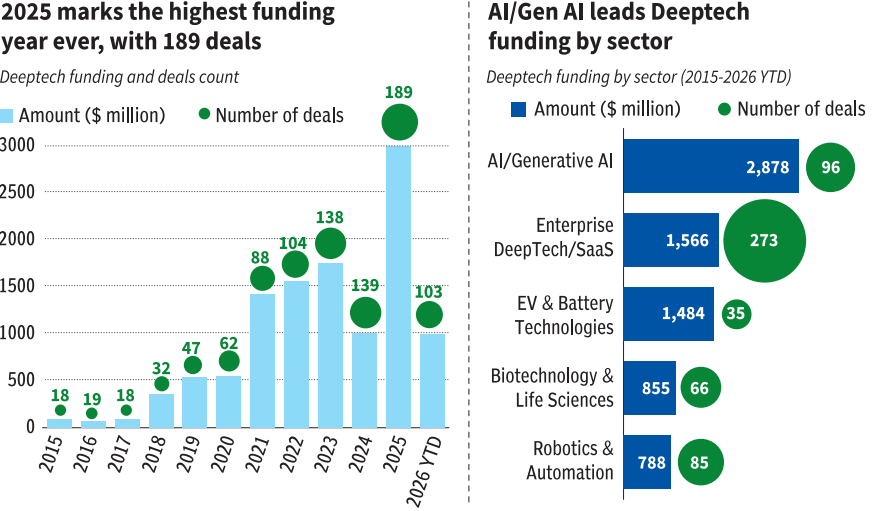
Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic: Visveswaran V

Record high

India’s Deeptech funding reached \$2.96 billion across 189 deals in 2025, even as overall start-up funding declined. According to the IVCA Bharat Deeptech Report 2026, the sector’s share of global VC funding also rose sharply to 36 per cent in 2025 from 14 per cent in 2016. EV & Battery Technologies, and AI emerged as the biggest areas of investment



INDIAN LANDSCAPE



EV & Battery Technologies attract the largest deals			
Capital concentration by sector			
Average deal size (\$ million)			
EV & Battery Technologies	42		
AI/Generative AI	30		
Mobility & Autonomous Systems	21		
Cybersecurity	16		
Biotechnology & Life Sciences	13		

Top 5 Deeptech deals			
Company	Amount (\$ million)	Years	Sector
TCS HyperVault	1,000	2025	Data Centres
Ola Electric	903.1	2019-23	EV & Battery
Ather Energy	436.5	2015-24	EV & Battery
Grey Orange Robotics	415	2015-23	Robotics
Biocon Biologics	330.9	2020-21	Biotech
Sarvam AI	287.6	2023-26	AI/Gen AI
NetraDyne	287.5	2016-25	AI/Computer Vision

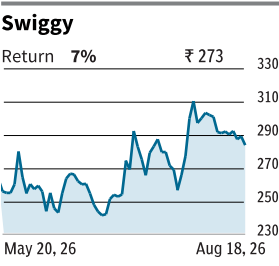
Source: IVCA Bharat Deeptech Report 2026

Swiggy expands leadership team as Instamart, food-delivery verticals scale

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Swiggy has expanded the responsibilities of three senior executives across its quick-commerce and food-delivery businesses as the company looks to strengthen its leadership bench.

Himavant Kurnala has been appointed Chief Growth and Product Officer at Instamart, while Nitesh Garg has been elevated as the CTO of the quick-commerce business. Saurav Goyal has been appointed COO of Swiggy’s food marketplace. Kurnala has been leading Instamart’s product function since 2024 and subsequently took on growth and brand marketing. In his expanded role, he will bring together growth, marketing, analytics, and product functions.



Garg, who has spent more than seven years at Swiggy, has been leading engineering for Instamart and New Initiatives as Senior Vice-President. He has been responsible for building Instamart’s consumer-facing technology stack and supply-chain systems since the business was launched. He has also developed technology platforms for advertising, pricing, discounting, and catalogues that are now used across Instamart, Food Marketplace and other busi-

nesses. As the Chief Technology Officer, Garg will be responsible for technology and engineering as Instamart scales further. Goyal, meanwhile, has held multiple roles at Swiggy since joining in 2020. His previous responsibilities included business finance for Food and Instamart and, more recently, driver and delivery product and operations. He will continue to oversee the driver and delivery function.

RESHUFFLE The appointments come as Swiggy continues to reshuffle and strengthen its senior leadership team. Nandita Sinha is the CEO of Instamart, while Gautam Swaroop is its CBO. Earlier this year, Swapnil Bajpai was elevated as CEO of Swiggy’s Dineout and Scenes business.

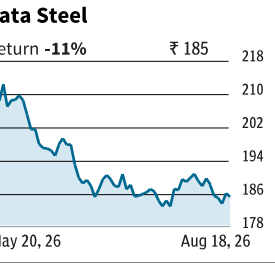
Tata Steel gets CCI nod to take additional stake in JV

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Competition Commission of India (CCI) on Tuesday approved Tata Steel’s proposed acquisition of an additional 23 per cent equity stake in TM International Logistics Ltd (TMILL).

TMILL is a joint venture among Tata Steel, IQ Martrade and NYK Europe. Following the proposed acquisition, Tata Steel will become the majority stakeholder, and IQ Martrade will exit from the JV entity.

IQ MARTRADE EXITS In a post on X (formerly Twitter), the regulator said, “CCI approves acquisition of 23 per cent equity shareholding of TM International Logistics Ltd by Tata Steel Ltd.” Deals beyond a certain threshold require approval



from the regulator, which keeps a watch on unfair business practices as well as promotes fair competition in the marketplace. Post consummation of the proposed combination, Tata Steel and NYK Europe will hold 74 and 26 per cent equity shareholding in TMILL respectively, the CCI said in a release. TMILL was incorporated as a JV primarily to cater to the logistics and cargo transportation requirements of Tata Steel.

Amazon’s India marketplace arm pares losses, FY26 revenue up 15%

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Amazon Seller Services Pvt Ltd, the marketplace arm of the e-commerce major in India, crossed the ₹35,000-crore mark in terms of total income in FY26, indicating volume growth. It posted a total income of ₹35,574 crore in FY26, up 15.5 per cent over ₹30,805 crore in FY25, as per a statutory RoC filing. The company narrowed its loss after tax to ₹389.9 crore in FY26 from ₹408.2 crore in FY25. At the same time, the e-commerce major turned profitable at the PBIT level during the year at ₹172 crore.

HUGE NETWORK The e-commerce major, which considers India a strategic market, has announced plans to make a total invest-

● BIG BET Amazon, which considers India a strategic market, aims to invest over \$48 b in the next four years

ment of \$48 billion between 2026 and 2030. These are meant for expanding Amazon’s operations network in the country and to boost AI and cloud infrastructure, among others. With this, Amazon’s cumulative investments in India from 2010 stand at over \$88 billion. In June, the e-commerce major stated that Amazon Now, its quick-commerce business had become the fastest growing e-commerce business unit in Amazon India’s history. Its orders have doubled

every quarter since launch. The company also said it was scaling up Amazon Now in over 300 cities across the country.

STRONG GROWTH During his India visit in June, Amazon Global CEO Andy Jassy said, “For over a decade, we have been serving customers, sellers, developers, startups, and enterprises through our different businesses. The response has been tremendous...” The e-commerce major, which has been ramping up its operations network, also announced plans to launch more than 20 new fulfilment centres and over 100 new last-mile delivery stations this year alone. It has also announced commitments to support 3.8 million jobs and \$80 billion in cumulative exports from India.

New vehicle architecture platform to aid Mahindra in EV push

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Mahindra & Mahindra is preparing to deepen its presence in India’s mass-market electric SUV segment through its NU_IQ architecture. This, after the automaker deliberately beginning its new-generation EV offensive higher up the price ladder, potentially setting up another reshaping of its lower-end electric portfolio.

The company consciously chose to establish its new EV

proposition at the premium end before working its way down, said Nalinikanth Gollagunta, CEO, Automotive Division.

COMPETITION HELPS Gollagunta sees increasing competition as helping expand, rather than fragment, the EV opportunity. New launches from rivals build confidence in the category and can bring incremental customers into electric vehicles, he indicated. For Mahindra, that expanding market comes as it prepares to take the technology and customer proposition established at the premium end into the much larger mass-market SUV battlefield through NU_IQ. The vehicle architecture is designed for compact and mid-sized SUVs and aims to support both internal combustion engine (ICE) and EVs. “We didn’t want to start

The company consciously chose to establish its new EV proposition at the premium end before working its way down

NALINIKANTH GOLLAGUNTA
CEO, Automotive Division



there. The strategy was to start from the top and then come down,” said Gollagunta, indicating that Mahindra has products planned in the 4-metre and 4.3-metre categories around NU_IQ.

PREMIUM BET The XEV 9e has emerged as the best-selling model in Mahindra’s born-electric portfolio, surpassing 34,000 units sold, and demonstrat-

ing that Indian buyers are willing to move beyond ₹20 lakh for a differentiated electric SUV. The XEV 9e has even outsold the Tata Nexon EV over some comparable sales periods. Now, Mahindra is now preparing to move in the other direction — taking its next-generation EV strategy towards the belly of the market through NU_IQ. The shift also puts the spotlight on the eventual

shape of Mahindra’s mass-market electric portfolio. At the upper end, the BE 6 and XEV range have established Mahindra’s born-electric proposition through dedicated EV architecture, larger batteries, and higher levels of technology.

WITHOUT A DOUBT While the eventual mix of models at the lower end is still taking shape, Mahindra sees no ambiguity about the direction of its powertrain strategy. “I really want to clear that matter. Our focus is electric, electric, electric,” R Velusamy, President, Automotive Business, said. Mahindra would therefore introduce electric powertrains into SUV segments where it sees an addressable market, rather than entering categories merely to add an EV. “Wherever there’s an SUV market, we bring electric,” Velusamy said.

CV monthly sales near 1 lakh mark as rural demand, infra drive growth

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Commercial vehicle (CV) retails at 99,666 units grew 24 per cent in July 2026 compared with the same period a year ago. The rural market led the pack, growing 29 per cent y-o-y against a 19 per cent upswing in the urban market, confirming that the goods movement demand continues to broaden beyond the metros, according to the Federation of Automobile Dealers Association (FADA). The EV share among CVs marked an all-time high of 4 per cent. Nonetheless, dealers remain watchful of the July price increases and input cost pressures on fleet operators’ ownership economics, said FADA. Dealers also cited cement,

Top five

	July 2025 sales (units)	Market share (%)	July 2026 sales (units)	Market share (%)
Tata Motors	26,162	32.56	34,733	34.85
Mahindra & Mahindra	21,296	26.5	26,055	26.14
Ashok Leyland	15,226	18.95	17,691	17.75
VE Commercial Vehicles	7,572	9.42	8,724	8.75
Maruti Suzuki	3,634	4.52	4,460	4.47

Source: FADA

steel and mining-linked movement, e-commerce logistics and improving finance availability, even as the school bus season demand tapered.

GROWTH DRIVERS The July numbers also show that India’s CV demand is entering a broader and more sustainable growth phase, said Bal Malkit Singh, CMD of the Mumbai-based Bal Roadlines. Rapid infrastructure development, replace-

ment of ageing vehicles, vehicle scrappage and stricter norms on older CVs are aiding the demand, said Singh, who is also former President of the All India Motor Transport Congress. Poonam Upadhyay of Crisil Ratings said e-commerce logistics and the expansion of last-mile delivery supported light CVs while infrastructure activity and freight movement drove the growth in medium and heavy commercial vehicles.

businessline.

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Pleasant surprise

India Inc Q1 numbers paint a picture of resilience

Listed companies were expected to get off to a rocky start in FY27 — thanks to rising energy costs, a looming El Nino and the ongoing Iran conflict. However, an analysis by this newspaper of results from 4220 listed companies portrays a picture of surprising resilience.



Total revenues for India Inc expanded at 20.9 per cent in Q1 FY27, accelerating from 10-13 per cent in the preceding three quarters of FY26. Only a part of this healthy topline expansion likely came from sales volumes. As the impact of the energy shock cascaded down to companies, they passed on input costs. Anecdotally, consumer durable makers hiked their selling prices by about 5-8 per cent this quarter, automobile and FMCG by 4-5 per cent, cement companies 5 per cent, paint companies 14-15 per cent and so on. However, the 21 per cent expansion in aggregate sales shows that these hikes didn't result in demand destruction. Companies clearly did not pass on input cost escalations in full, as the aggregate operating profit margin (OPM) fell to 18.2 per cent in Q1 FY27 from 20.4 per cent a year ago. Net profit growth moderated to 13.6 per cent from over 17 per cent in the previous two quarters. However, this is still a surprisingly healthy pace of growth.

A deeper dive reveals contrasting trends. On the positive side, there were standout sectoral performers for the quarter from power and electrical equipment and high-end manufacturing. The 31 per cent sales growth for electrical equipment makers, 28 per cent from aerospace and defense, 60 per cent in electronics and over 44 per cent in cables represent the opportunities arising from the global clean energy transition and rising capex in defense and electronics. That affluent consumers were little affected by geopolitics is evident from discretionary consumption remaining strong, with a 78 per cent growth in e-commerce, 75 per cent in jewellery, 20 per cent in durables and 17 per cent in automobiles. Despite higher inflation and a cloud over the rural economy, consumer staples did reasonably well with an 18 per cent sales growth in FMCG, 12 per cent in readymades and 19 per cent in retail trade.

Whether this sustains if inflation picks up and the monsoon ends badly, remains to be seen. On the negative side, given the fluid Iran situation, the 25-40 per cent sales growth managed by commodity-driven sectors such as refineries, metals and chemicals needs to be read with caution. Several sectors are faced with severe profitability pressures — cement, automobiles, aviation, for instance. IT services and banking, two employment generating sectors, put up only a modest show. Falling employee costs-to-sales suggests that India Inc has been frugal with wages. Overall, India Inc's Q1 numbers reinforce trends from the high-frequency indicators — which show the Indian economy chugging along well despite external risks. A rate hike to tame inflation may not upset this momentum. Double-digit earnings growth may help put a floor to the ongoing stock market correction.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



Dynamics of credit, deposit growth

VITAL ASPECTS. Too much credit growth can cause inflation and too little can constrain growth. Quality of credit matters



C RANGARAJAN
B SAMBAMURTHY

Over the last five years (2022-2026), credit growth rate has been outpacing deposit growth rate. There has been a lot of media buzz implying subtly that this creates liquidity crisis and even financial stability issue. Credit/Deposit ratio had gone up from 70 per cent to nearly 82 per cent. Focussing on gaps in growth rates to the exclusion of gaps in absolute amount may not tell the full story because the base for the two are different. As seen from Table 1, deposits growth rate lagged credit growth rate by 5 per cent, 7 per cent, 1 per cent and 4.5 per cent during the four-year period 2023-2026, respectively. In absolute terms, the gap is only ₹1 lakh crore, ₹3 lakh crore, (-) ₹4 lakh crore, and ₹1 lakh crore respectively. This absolute gap is hardly 1-1.5 per cent of the deposit base and may not by any stretch of imagination threaten financial stability.

Credit growth rate outpacing deposit growth rate is not new. It has been the norm for most part of 2000-2020. RBI Annual report bears this out. The average deposit growth rate during the 10-year period of 2000-2010 was 18.1 per cent, lagging behind credit growth rate of 22.4 per cent. This, however, is not a sustainable growth model.

LOANABLE FUNDS

While analysing the gap in absolute terms it is important to note that not all deposits are available for providing credit. CRR and SLR are pre-emptions out of deposits. Therefore, one has to calculate the available loanable funds. But the available funds are also affected by two other factors, one is the increase in capital stock and long term borrowings and the other is the change in CRR and SLR. For example, in the recent period CRR was brought down from 4.5 per cent in 2024 to 3 per cent in 2026. SLR came down from 21.25 per cent in 2016 to 18 per cent in 2020 and has remained at that level since then. Thus, looking at the problem from the point of view of individual banks the comparison must be the total availability

TABLE 1 Deposit and credit growth				
Item	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26
Deposits (increase) (₹ lakh crore)	19	27	24	26
Deposit growth (%)	11	14	11	11
Credit (increase) (₹ lakh crore)	20	30	20	27
Credit growth (%)	16	21	12	14
Credit minus Deposit growth (₹ lakh crore)	1	3	(4)	1

TABLE 2 Loanable funds and credit growth						
Particulars	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	June 2026
Loanable deposits (₹ lakh cr)	132	147	168	190	206	210
Credit outstanding (₹ lakh cr)	121	141	171	191	213	219
Credit/loanable deposits (%)	91.5	96	101	100	103	104
Repo borrowing (market/tripartite) (₹ lakh cr)	11	14	13	15	17	13
Certificate of deposits (₹ lakh cr)	2	3	3	5	6.5	7
SLR (%)	18	18	18	18	18	18
CRR (%)	4.5	4.5	4.5	3	3	3
SLR investment/deposit ratio (%)	29	30	29	-	27	28.5

*Loan-able deposits are calculated by deducting SLR/CRR from deposits

of loanable funds and credit dispersal.

From the available data (Table 2), the outstanding loanable deposits cover outstanding credit till 2025. However, this trend has changed in 2026 and the outstanding credit surpasses loanable deposits and the gap widened for June quarter. This needs to be monitored even though there is no systemic issue as of now. There is less scope for further reduction in CRR. SLR investments at 28.5 per cent, are far in excess of the RBI requirement of 18 per cent. Some of the banks with significant lag of deposit growth are using excess SLR for repo borrowings in the market which are quite significant and reached a high of ₹17 lakh crore. Banks also raised funds through infrastructure/green Tier 2 bonds and owned funds increased significantly as profits and plough back have improved.

When it comes to regulation of credit, the central bank plays twin roles, as a monetary authority and as a regulator

AGGREGATIVE PICTURE

Text books on money and banking present an alternative view on the relationship between credit and deposits. It is argued that in a fractional reserve system, lending leads to multiple creation of deposits.

A bank is willing to lend say 90 per cent of the deposits because reserve requirement and customer behaviour in withdrawing cash taken together do not exceed 10 per cent of the deposits. When a bank lends, it creates in favour of the borrower a deposit.

As the borrower uses the deposit, the amount goes as deposit to another bank. That is why the saying every loan makes a deposit.

Thus the whole process results in multiple creation of deposits. This is possible because: (a) banks need to keep only a fraction of deposits in the form of cash; and (b) what one bank loses, another bank gains. The only exception is when a part of the deposits is withdrawn as cash.

So if 'r' denotes the required reserve requirement as a percentage of deposits and 'e' is the proportion of deposits withdrawn in cash (sometimes called

Tapping Northeast's renewable energy potential

The region does not lack capital. Its real test is whether transmission, storage and project execution can match generation

Rouhin Deb
Nikhil Sinha

The Northeast is emerging as one of the most consequential theatres of India's renewable-energy transition. Assam has announced a ₹77,353-crore investment roadmap to expand generation, while Arunachal Pradesh is working towards nearly 19 GW of commissioned hydropower capacity against a resource base the state estimates at more than 50 GW. The scale of the ambition is striking. Yet the central question is no longer whether the region can attract capital or announce capacity. It is whether it can build the grid required to convert that capacity into usable economic power.

That distinction matters. The Northeast's electricity challenge is often folded into the wider story of financially stressed state utilities. But the region's constraint is of a different order. Unlike states where distribution losses have been aggravated by large subsidy burdens, much of the Northeast's problem lies in decades of under-built transmission infrastructure, delayed execution and weak capitalisation of projects. In other words, the bottleneck is less about the absence of money than about the ability to move electricity reliably from where it is generated to where it can be consumed.

The gap between potential and utilisation shows how large the unfinished task remains. Only about 4 per cent of the region's estimated 130

GW renewable potential — including 66 GW of hydropower potential — is currently utilised. The historical record has been one of prolonged delays. More recently, central public-sector undertakings such as NHPC have stepped in to take over distressed state assets and restart stalled construction. This can help revive generation. But generation alone does not create an energy economy.

For that, power must reach new centres of demand. Assam's ₹27,000-crore Tata Electronics chip-assembly facility, the Sabroom Special Economic Zone in Tripura, and Sikkim's pharmaceutical manufacturing base are examples of the industrial opportunities that could give the region's energy build-out an economic multiplier. Their success will depend not merely on installed megawatts but on the quality, stability and reach of the transmission network serving them.

STORAGE CAPACITY

Storage is the other side of the equation. Assam's Pumped Storage Power Policy, 2025, has approved four projects with a combined capacity of 4,900 MW. Pumped storage can absorb cheap surplus electricity during periods of low demand and release it when demand rises or solar generation falls. In principle, this can give the grid the flexibility needed to integrate more renewable power. In practice, however, pumped storage is only as useful as the transmission system connected to it.

The Northeast also presents unusually demanding engineering



KEY ISSUE. Under-built transmission infra, delayed execution of projects

conditions. Large parts of the region fall in Seismic Zone V. Pumped-storage projects involving dual reservoirs must therefore contend with risks such as water ingress, slope instability and cave-ins.

The more persistent problem is the gap between sanctioned transmission expenditure and assets actually commissioned on the ground.

This is where regulatory reform can make a difference. One option is to link approvals and disbursements more closely to measurable construction milestones and actual capitalisation rather than to proposed expenditure alone. Such a framework would reward delivery, make delays more visible and reduce the distance between utility plans and completed infrastructure.

The Northeast's energy deficit therefore cannot be understood simply through the familiar lens of fiscal indiscipline. Its core weakness is infrastructure that has not expanded at

cash leakage), the increase in deposits becomes $\Delta D \approx \Delta R / (r + c)$.

There are other sophisticated versions of this formula. But in substance, this is represented as the model of deposit and credit expansion. ΔR comes as a result of central bank action. If banks are not able to lend because of lack of demand, the deposit multiplier becomes smaller. The formula given earlier sets the upper limit. Banks may keep more reserves than the reserve requirement ratio stipulated by the central banks for other reasons such as, uncertainty and customer behaviour. This process of deposit creation somewhat under cuts the view that banks are 'financial intermediaries'. It is perhaps true that some part of the deposits is not the result of credit dispensation. Credit initially creates only Current Account deposits.

While at the aggregate level the overall deposits may be conditioned by central banks actions in creating reserves, banks may regard deposits as the source of loans. That is still a good approach. Credit growth cannot be unrestrained without limit. Of course, central bank can control overall credit growth by acting on the reserves. That, it should do, depending on the situation. Controlling money (deposit) growth is an important responsibility of the central bank. It should be noted that adjustment of policy rate is not independent of adjusting reserve money and consequently deposit growth. They are concomitant decisions. When it comes to regulation of credit, the central bank plays twin roles, as a monetary authority and as a regulator. Even risk weights are adjusted to regulate flow for specific sectors. Prescription of capital adequacy ratio as well as liquidity ratio is meant to restrain long term credit growth and ensure the soundness of banks.

Overall credit growth is an important dimension to watch. Too much can explode into inflation and too little can constrain growth. Linking credit growth to deposit growth is only one aspect. There are a host of other issues related to credit expansion such as quality of credit that need to be kept in view.

Rangarajan is former Chairman to Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council and former Governor, RBI. Sambamurthy is formerly Director and CEO, IDBRT and led a commercial bank

the pace demanded by geography, industry and new generation capacity.

There is also a social and strategic dimension to this transition. Large hydro and storage projects in ecologically and politically sensitive areas need more than statutory clearance. Models that give tribal communities a share in financially viable projects can help move them from being petitioners at the edge of decision-making to stakeholders in the assets being created.

Hydropower development in Arunachal Pradesh also has implications beyond electricity markets. Down-river infrastructure and a stronger Indian presence in the Brahmaputra basin intersect with questions of downstream riparian interests and water security at a time when China is expanding upstream dam construction. Energy planning in the Northeast, therefore, sits at the intersection of economic development, federal infrastructure, ecological risk and strategic policy.

The lesson is straightforward. The Northeast does not need generation targets and transmission plans to proceed on separate tracks. They must be built as one system. A gigawatt generated at a riverhead in Arunachal Pradesh or a solar facility in Assam has limited economic value if the grid cannot evacuate it, store it when necessary and deliver it to industry or the national market.

Deb is Chief Economist, Chief Minister's Secretariat, Assam, and Sinha is Mukherjee Fellow, Policy, Politics and Governance Foundation. Views are personal

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US tariff circumvention

This refers to 'Trading charges' (August 18). In the short term Indian exporters could face more customs scrutiny and possible retrospective tariff claims if US authorities find false origin declarations. The US has a legitimate concern about tariff circumvention, but allegations like India is deliberately helping China evade US tariffs require strong evidence on a shipment or company. The best strategy for India is to cooperate on genuine customs fraud while strengthening rules of origin enforcement. If India tightens origin

verification and demonstrates that its exports represent genuine value addition, we could strengthen our position as China +1 manufacturing hub.

Bal Govind
Noida

US-Iran peace framework

The 60-day window for the US and Iran to agree on a long-term peace framework expired on Monday. Far from limiting hostilities, this period saw the war widen, with the Iran-backed Houthis and Saudi Arabia attacking each other as the

Yemen-based militant group enforced a partial blockade of the Bab-el-Mandeb. Both the US and Iran are now doubling down on economic warfare. With midterm elections approaching, President Trump needs to show that his pressure campaign is producing results without dragging the country into another foreign war. Iran, meanwhile, calculates that it can outlast Trump until the midterms and sees the current stalemate as an acceptable new balance of power. Given the threat this deadlock poses to India's economic, energy, and

strategic interests, India must reduce its dependence on imported oil, build larger strategic petroleum reserves, and invest aggressively in alternative energy sources.

M Jeyaram
Sholavandan, TN

Save forests

The CAG report reveals that the Green India Mission restored just 0.11 million hectares of forest, missing its 1.4 million hectare target by over 91 per cent. Instead of saving real habitats the state boasts of planting 140 crore saplings under

promotional drives. However, out of 1,445 sq km added in green cover, only 156 sq km is actual forest, while 1,289 sq km is merely roadside or urban tree cover. Planted saplings cannot replace natural ecosystems that took thousands of years to evolve. The government must stop chasing empty numbers and protect real forests, wildlife and native habitats before they are lost forever. True restoration requires stopping illegal mining and saving our wild lands for future generations.

Vijaykumar HK
Raichur, Karnataka

Organic and exciting

Gorkha Haat’s success story can be replicated

Mohit Sharma

Every Thursday, a stretch of low footfall mall space in Kalimpong turns into something more interesting than a shopping centre.

Only local produce is allowed in, and sellers pool their risk through a cooperative, which can help cover a hospital bill or school fees if a member’s harvest fails. That rule has carried the Gorkha Haat model from Kalimpong to Darjeeling’s Gundri Bazaar and on to Siliguri. Bihar has spent six years and hundreds of crores building an organic corridor along the Ganga. It still has to bring anything like that.

The Jaivik Corridor, launched in 2020 and extended to 2025, has brought more than 20,000 farmers across 13 riverbank districts into certified organic cultivation, with roughly ₹24,500 per acre in support over three years. But reports on the scheme note that many enrolled farmers hardly see price premium for going organic, because there is no market that treats their produce as different from ordinary grain sold at the local markets.

FARMER CLUSTERS

This is exactly the gap the Gorkha Haat model was built to close, and Bihar already has the institutional strength to try it. Jeevika, the State’s rural livelihoods mission, has mobilised over a crore rural household into more than 10 lakh self-help groups, federated into Village Organisations and Cluster Level Federations (CLF) across 38 districts. That is a working cooperative structure, already running community kitchens, rural marts, and e-commerce tie-ups. What it lacks is a periodic haat for organic produce, that too in urban circuits.

Jeevika Organic Haat’s initiatives, such as farmer clusters within the corridor, CLFs handling logistics and rental pooling, weekly or biweekly markets in district towns, can pave the way for sustainable forward linkages. It borrows the Gorkha Haat’s core insight, that a market works for smallholders only when someone above them absorbs the risk of a bad week.

In Bihar, the CLF can play that role, using tools the State already has, including the ₹2,000 crore GrAM and AMIP fund.

But setting up a haat is only half the job. What is more crucial is creating demand through awareness, storytelling, and direct contact between growers and urban consumers.



ORGANIC PRODUCE. Dedicated markets

Bihar got a working demonstration of this in December 2025, when Patna hosted the seventh edition of the Himalayan Orange Festival.

Over three days at City Centre Mall, 19 stalls brought communities from Sikkim, Darjeeling, Nepal, Bhutan, Himachal Pradesh, and Siliguri to of Patna’s residents, drawing more than 5,000 visitors. What made it work was not the orange itself but that farmers, women’s collectives, and homestay operators stood at their own stalls and explained where their produce came from.

That is the missing piece for the organic corridor. A Jeevika Organic Haat should not just be a weekly stall rotation. It should borrow the festival’s instinct for storytelling, invite farmers to speak with buyers, tie haat days to seasonal showcases, and use tourism to pull in visitors who would not otherwise seek out a vegetable market. The template that worked for Himalayan produce could work for Ganga-riverside farmers; they could benefit, like Kalimpong’s and Sikkim’s orange growers.

A modest pilot in three or four districts (Patna, Vaishali, and Bhagalpur are obvious choices) could test whether a monthly haat, paired with this storytelling approach, delivers a price premium within a year. The Himalayan model took years to prove itself. Bihar can borrow a blueprint that already works.

What is missing is not organic acreage, certification, or institutional capacity. It is a market day, and reason for the city to show up for it. Until Bihar’s organic farmers have this support, the corridor along the Ganga will keep producing chemical-free crops that sell for the same price as everything else, a quiet subsidy to consumers alone.

The writer is Assistant Professor RPCAU, Pusa. Views expressed are personal

Paradigm shift in oil exploration

Under Samudra Manthan, Centre will go beyond being a regulator to sharing risks with the private sector. Will it work?

CAPITAL IDEAS.



RICHA MISHRA

Will India get lucky in its third attempt at hydrocarbon hunt through the Cabinet-approved ₹84,084 crore ‘Samudra Manthan’ scheme, or will this just be another expensive mistake?

This time, the government is putting its own money on the line. The ‘Samudra Manthan’ or National Offshore Exploration Scheme marks a fundamental shift from India’s traditional policy-reform approach to an active, state-funded, mission-mode framework.

Past regulatory overhauls couldn’t fix India’s deepwater stagnation. The New Exploration Licensing Policy regime relied on complex production-sharing contracts, the existing Hydrocarbon Exploration and Licensing Policy (HELP) and Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) offer fiscal incentives (such as revenue sharing and marketing freedom). But, they leave the massive financial and geological risks of deepwater drilling entirely on the corporate explorers.

Under Samudra Manthan, the government is stepping into the trenches as a financial risk-sharer and infrastructure builder. Under this new blueprint, the government will directly co-fund 50 per cent of high-risk exploratory wells and finance common sub-sea pipelines to unlock India’s ultra-deepwater basins.

UNLOCKING POTENTIAL

According to the government, the Scheme translates the Prime Minister’s vision, articulated from the Red Fort on Independence Day 2025, of a modern-day Samudra Manthan to unlock India’s vast offshore energy potential. Its objective is to strengthen India’s energy security, accelerating domestic exploration and production and promote technological leadership.

The scheme encompasses a comprehensive set of interventions



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

across the offshore exploration value chain. It provides for large-scale acquisition, processing and interpretation of high-quality seismic data, accelerated deepwater and ultra-deepwater exploratory drilling, scientific drilling in frontier basins, development of common offshore production and evacuation infrastructure, and establishment of an integrated oil and gas manufacturing and services zone.

It also includes dedicated provisions for digital programme management, capacity building, technology adoption, stakeholder engagement and international outreach, creating an integrated ecosystem to accelerate offshore exploration and production in the country.

It is expected to catalyse reserve accretion of over 600 Million Metric Tonnes of Oil Equivalent (MMTOE),

Under the scheme, the government will directly co-fund 50 per cent of high-risk exploratory wells and finance common sub-sea pipelines to unlock India’s ultra-deepwater basins

substantially increase offshore exploration activity, promote higher domestic oil and gas production, generate large-scale employment, strengthen domestic manufacturing under Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat, and foster a globally competitive ecosystem for offshore technologies and services. The scheme is also expected to stimulate significant investments across the exploration and production value chain, creating long-term opportunities for industry, innovation and economic growth.

Over the past decade, the government has undertaken transformative reforms across the upstream sector, including opening almost the entire offshore acreage for exploration, modernising the legislative and contractual framework, and strengthening the National Data Repository. Building on these reforms, Samudra Manthan will usher in a new era of accelerated offshore exploration through strategic public investment, cutting-edge technologies and world-class infrastructure.

THE CHALLENGES

But critics say this is a desperate measure by the government to boost India’s hydrocarbon production and attract big players. It is not exactly a PLI scheme but definitely shifts away from production sharing contract regime.

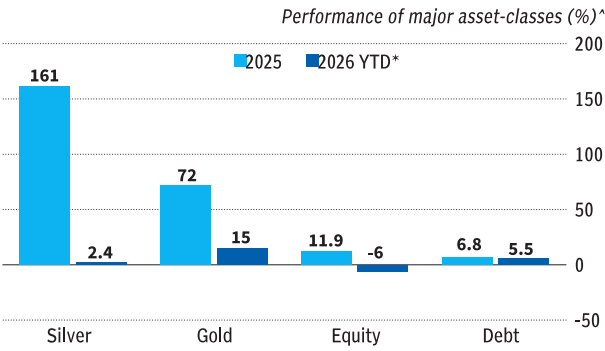
STATISTALK.

Compiled Dhuraveil Gunasekaran | Graphic Visveswaran V

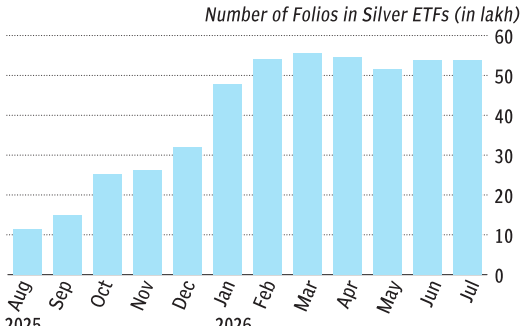
Silver ETFs: The FOMO fades, but investors stay

Silver ETFs have gone from a high-octane rally to a period of consolidation. After delivering a stunning 161 per cent return in 2025, the category has gained just 2.4 per cent so far in 2026. The cooling is visible across key indicators. AUM fell 33% from its January peak of ₹1.17 lakh crore to ₹77,676 crore in July. The sharpest change has been visible in trading activity, with exchange volumes falling more than 90% from January highs, indicating that speculative enthusiasm has cooled. Yet the relatively stable folio base suggests investors continue to view silver as a strategic portfolio allocation rather than a short-term trade.

Silver’s stunning run loses steam in 2026

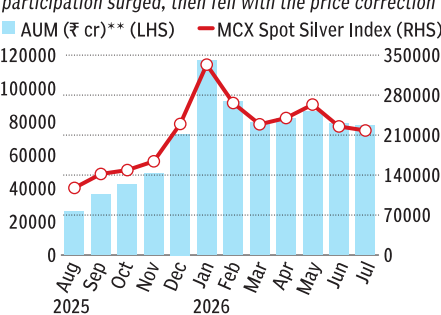


Number of folios have plateaued lately, but remain above 50 lakh mark



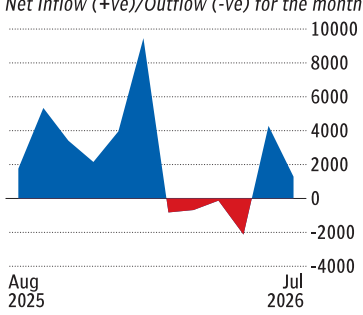
AUM drops one-third from January peak

AUM crossed ₹1 lakh crore as prices and participation surged, then fell with the price correction



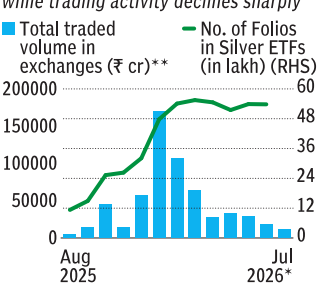
Inflows turned to outflows in Feb-May as the rally lost steam

Net Inflow (+ve)/Outflow (-ve) for the month



Investors remain, traders disappear

Investor accounts remain elevated while trading activity declines sharply



*Silver and gold refer to their respective ETF category averages; equity refers to Nifty 50 TRI; debt refers to the composite bond index data as provided by the AMCS. Source: AMFI, ACEMF, Bloomberg, NSE and BSE a blportfolio compilation **as of Aug 17, 2026. **on the both NSE and BSE for the overall Silver ETFs

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

August 19, 2006

Govt unhappy with IOC’s non-fuel retailing foray

Indian Oil Corporation’s plan to enter non-fuel retailing in a big way appears to be headed for trouble with the Government. Even as the company is preparing the blueprint for the pro posed foray, a senior official in the Petroleum Ministry has indicated that the Government may not approve the company’s plans.

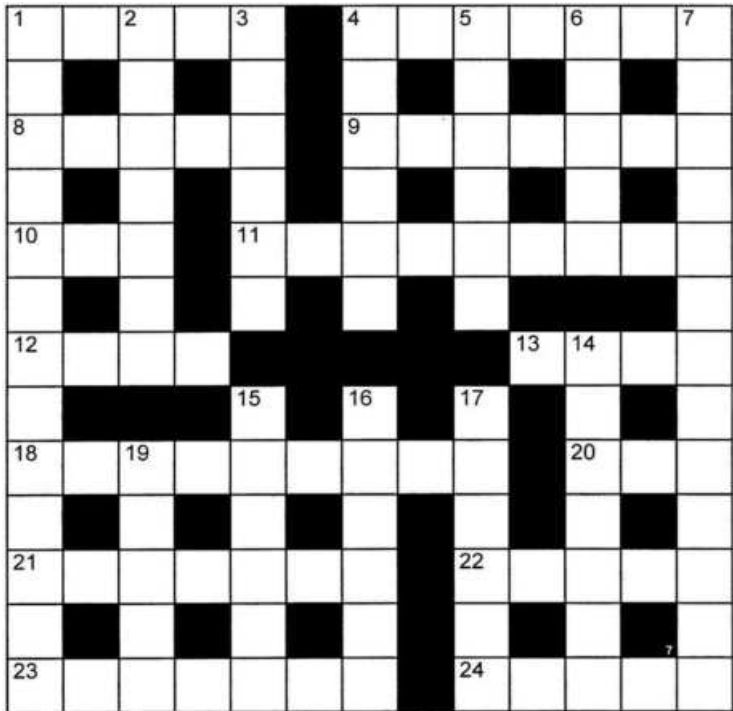
Govt rejects States’ demand for greater service tax share

The Finance Ministry has formally turned down the States’ request for 50 per cent devolution of service tax collections as part of the compensation package for proposed Central sales tax (CST) phase-out. The States currently get 30.5 per cent of all Central tax collections, including service tax. Sources in the Government said that the suggestions involving additional cash outgo from the Centre had been turned down.

TN seeks jt venture route for Chennai airport revamp

The Tamil Nadu Government has written to the Centre asking that the model followed for development of airports in Delhi and Mumbai be adopted for the proposed modernisation of the Chennai airport.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2717



EASY

ACROSS

- Herb flavouring pesto (5)
- Shellfish (7)
- Approximately (5)
- Japanese battered, fried food (7)
- Stain (3)
- Will not rust or tarnish (9)
- Laying structure (4)
- A footway (4)
- Treatment by plant remedies (9)
- No longer available or being served (3)
- To hoot, screech (7)
- Pigment, red or yellow (5)
- Nicely turned out (7)
- Had on charter (5)

DOWN

- Residence accommodating guests (8,5)
- Brief spells of rain (7)
- Most recent (6)
- Ostentatiously rich person (6)
- Flavouring of ratafia (6)
- Head-infesting parasite (5)
- Spreads affections over a wide range (5,3,5)
- One more (7)
- Yellow fruit (6)
- Straight there (6)
- Having an even surface (6)
- Course travelled (5)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Lab is turning out plant cooks use (5)
- Coquille one will cut in curves along the edge (7)
- An attack of ‘flu here and there? (5)
- Rum paté as prepared by Japanese chef (7)
- In making mustard yellow, it will change colour (3)
- It sent Silas mad, being without a blemish (9)
- It isn’t, in France, a cosy home (4)
- Have some sympathy with the way one walks (4)
- A lady’s balm is perhaps used for treatment by medicinal plants (9)
- Is leaving, not being switched on (3)
- At tea, Lulu might howl and wail (7)
- Pigment might echo red primarily (5)
- Given a gentle twist, it is graceful in form (7)
- May be taken on or leased out (5)

DOWN

- Getting on with residence that will accommodate strangers (8,5)
- Those who demonstrate bathroom fittings? (7)
- The most recent news is farthest behind schedule (6)
- Sex appeal, a snare for a rich and tyrannical man (6)
- Old man might be considered a nut (6)
- Parasite that’s met with in parlous extremes (5)
- Spreads one’s love around pally set if he’d make it up (5,3,5)
- Repeat order for somebody different? (7)
- It’s a handy sort of fruit (6)
- To superintend stage production, go straight to it (6)
- Moth so unusual to find without without hair (6)
- How to rue the path one’s following (5)

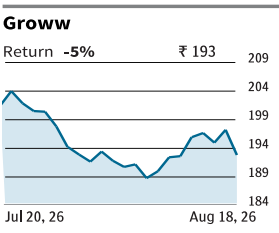
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2716

ACROSS 1. Perpetrator 8. Using 9. Thrones 10. Cistern 11. Unity 12. Speech 14. Chaste 18. Level 19. Teacher 21. Bambino 23. Boron 24. Regulations

DOWN 1. Pounces 2. Reissue 3. Eagle 4. Rating 5. Through 6. Run 7. Musty 13. Calling 15. Scherzo 16. Errands 17. Stroll 18. Libel 20. Ambit 22. Mar

QUICKLY.

Y Combinator sells 1.2% in Groww for ₹1,435 crore



New Delhi: Start-up accelerator Y Combinator on Tuesday divested nearly a 1.2 per cent stake in Billionbrains Garage Ventures, the parent company of Groww, for ₹1,435 crore in the open market. US-based Y Combinator through its affiliate YC Holdings II, LLC, sold a total of about 7.47 crore shares at an average price of ₹192.16. After the latest transaction, YC Holdings II LLC's shareholding in the stock broking firm declined to 7.44 per cent from 8.63 per cent. Details of the buyers of Billionbrains Garage Ventures' shares could not be ascertained on the exchange. In May, Y Combinator sold a 1.45 per cent stake in Groww for ₹1,642 crore. **■**

Invesco MF launches India Pharma, Healthcare NFO

Mumbai: Invesco Mutual Fund has launched the India Pharma and Healthcare Fund, which will invest in pharmaceutical firms, hospitals, diagnostics, contract development and manufacturing organisations, contract research organisations, medical devices, healthcare services, insurance and other allied healthcare segments. The fund seeks to capitalise on India's evolving healthcare ecosystem, which is being shaped by favourable demographics, expanding healthcare access and rising insurance penetration. The fund will be managed by Aditya Khemani and will be benchmarked against the BSE Healthcare TRI. The NFO closes for subscription on September 1. **OUR BUREAU**

Nifty slides for 6th straight day

ON THE BACK FOOT. Rising crude, geopolitical tensions keep equities under pressure



VALUE BUYING. The Nifty Smallcap 100 ended flat even as the Nifty Midcap 100 slipped 0.43%, indicating selective buying interest in the small-cap segment amid overall weak sentiment

ing the expiration of the temporary US-Iran ceasefire, heightening concerns about renewed inflation,” said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments.

SECTORAL PRESSURE IT bore the brunt of the sell-off, with the Nifty IT index declining nearly 2 per cent for the third straight session. Realty, PSU Banks and FMCG also faced sustained selling pressure. Healthcare,

Auto and Media bucked the trend, ending in positive territory.

Analysts see limited near-term relief. “Elevated crude prices, geopolitical uncertainty and foreign selling are likely to keep near-term sentiment subdued,” said Siddhartha Khemka of Motilal Oswal, adding that resilient domestic fundamentals and policy support could offer a “constructive medium-term backdrop”.

Citi sets June 2027 Nifty target at 26,800

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

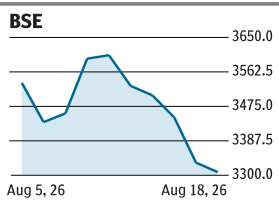
Citi remains constructive on Indian equities and has set a June 2027 target of 26,800 for the Nifty 50, based on an 18x one-year forward price-to-earnings multiple. The investment advisory firm is favouring financials, telecom, healthcare and utilities, while remaining underweight on IT services, staples and metals. Citi identified GST tailwinds, wage hikes and credit growth as positive drivers for equities. At the same time, it flagged AI productivity impact and elevated crude costs as key risks.

BSE slumps on Jefferies, Nuvama downgrade due to fresh headwinds

Our Bureau
Mumbai

BSE shares closed 0.72 per cent lower at ₹3,308 on Tuesday, after hitting a four-month low of ₹3,235, despite the exchange set to enter the Nifty 50 index from September 30. The stock is facing mounting pressure from regulatory headwinds, prompting fresh downgrades from a couple of brokerages.

‘TRIPLE WHAMMY’ Jefferies downgraded BSE to ‘Underperform’ from ‘Hold’, cutting its price target by 16 per cent to ₹2,940, citing a “triple whammy” of the securities transaction tax hike, tighter RBI bank-guarantee norms raising collateral costs, and the new closing auction session (CAS) that has already cut options average daily premium turnover by roughly 12 per cent in August. It trimmed its FY27-29



EPS estimates by 5-12 per cent, warning of further downside if market-share gains stall.

Nuvama Institutional Equities also downgraded BSE to ‘Hold’ from ‘Buy’, slashing its price target to ₹3,240 from ₹4,090. It cut FY27 and FY28 EPS estimates by 6.3 per cent and 15 per cent, modelling the remaining FY27 average daily premium turnover at approximately ₹18,600 crore against an earlier estimate of ₹24,100 crore.

BSE's ADPTV hit ₹18,100 crore last week, its lowest since January 2025. CAS introduced to align Indian markets with developed

market practices, has disrupted BSE's expiry-day trading.

LOSING VOLUME BSE contracts fell 30.5 per cent week-on-week in the first post-CAS week, from 150 million to 104 million contracts. Nuvama said that expiry-day trading historically accounts for 70-79 per cent of BSE's weekly contracts, making the exchange disproportionately exposed to CAS-related disruption compared to rivals.

The bearish analyst sentiment arrives just as NSE confirmed BSE will replace Wipro in the Nifty 50 from September 30.

JM Financial estimates that this will trigger inflows of about \$650 million into BSE. The stock has returned about 33 per cent over the past year but fallen over 8 per cent in the past week, reflecting the sharp reassessment of its near-term earnings trajectory.

Torrent Gas to file updated DRHP for ₹4,000-cr IPO

Reuters

Torrent Gas aims to file updated draft papers for an initial public offering of up to ₹4,000 crore as early as this week, two sources aware of the matter told *Reuters*.

The company, which supplies piped natural gas (PNG) to households and industries in eight States and one Union Territory in India, is part of the Ahmedabad-based Torrent Group.

Torrent Gas supplies PNG to over 2,00,000 households and more than 1,300 industries, while also operating about 500 compressed natural gas (CNG) stations, according to its website.

The company did not immediately respond to a *Reuters* request for comment on its IPO plans.

SEBI had approved Torrent Gas' confidential IPO filing in June. The updated draft red herring prospectus, expected this week, will be the company's first public IPO document.

The filing comes at a time when India's primary market activity has picked up substantially after a muted first half of the year due to the Iran war-driven spike in crude oil prices. As many as 27 companies have either launched or announced their IPOs since July, nearly matching the 28 recorded in the first half of 2026.

India Exposition Mart files IPO papers with SEBI

Our Bureau
Chennai

India Exposition Mart Ltd has filed its draft red herring prospectus with SEBI to launch an initial public offering.

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to 75 lakh shares and an OFS of up to 2.3 crore shares by selling shareholders.

The company operates an integrated exhibition and convention centre under the brand name “India Expo Centre and Mart” in Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh.

The shares will be listed on the BSE and the NSE.

Milky Mist jumps 30% to ₹181.50 on listing day

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Shares of Milky Mist Dairy Food ended its debut day on a strong note with 30 per cent listing gains.

The stock debuted on the NSE and the BSE at ₹165, a 17.8 per cent premium over the IPO price of ₹140.

It then strengthened further to close at the upper circuit on the NSE and the BSE at ₹181.50 and ₹181.45 respectively, 30 per cent higher than the offer price.

Meanwhile, DAM Capital has initiated a ‘Buy’ call on Milky Mist with ₹175 as the target price.

Swastika Investmart Ltd's Head of Wealth, Shivani Nyati, said Milky Mist Dairy



CREAMY DELIGHT. (from left) Ashish Chauhan, MD and CEO, NSE, with T Satish Kumar, CMD, Milky Mist Dairy Food and K Rathnam, Whole-time Director and CEO, at the listing ceremony

Food's strong revenue CAGR of 33.6 per cent, expanding margins, 32 per cent RoE and leadership in the value-added dairy segment support its premium positioning. However, she said that the stock is valued around 85x FY26 earnings, significantly above the dairy sector aver-

age of about 52.5x P/E.

Earlier, Milky Mist Dairy Food IPO received a strong response, with the issue being subscribed 56.12 times.

Qualified institutional buyers led the demand, with 155.83 times subscription followed by non-institutional investors 34.91 times,

and retail investors 8.40 times. The employee portion too saw strong demand of 12.41 times.

The ₹1,553-crore IPO had a price band of ₹133-140 and comprised a fresh issue (₹1,428 crore) and an OFS (₹125 crore).

Ahead of IPO, the company raised ₹465.30 crore from anchor investors.

The issue is the largest IPO by an Indian dairy company. Listed peers in the sector include Parag Milk Foods, Hatsun Agro Product and Doodla Dairy.

The IPO comes after Milky Mist raised about ₹482 crore in a pre-IPO round in May from Jongsong Investments Pte Ltd, an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Temasek Holdings.

SEBI settlement overhaul may offer exit for cases stuck in SAT, courts

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India's proposed overhaul of its settlement framework could give parties a wider route to resolve enforcement cases that have already reached the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) or the Supreme Court, potentially resolving the long-pending backlog of cases.

SEBI has proposed to remove the existing 60-day limitation that closes the settlement route early in the enforcement process, keeping the doors to settlement open even after the proceedings are placed before SAT or the Supreme Court.

PENDING APPEALS

The proposed overhaul comes as SEBI has 1,066 appeals pending before SAT and 539 cases before the Supreme Court, while 620 involving recovery certificates are *sub judice* before various courts and tribunals. “Settlement should be en-

couraged at every stage of the enforcement lifecycle. In fact, the possibility of settlement can sometimes become stronger during an appeal because the issues have crystallised, the evidence has been tested and both sides have a much clearer assessment of litigation risk,” said Sumit Agrawal, Managing Partner and former SEBI officer at Regstreet Advisors.

Ankit Rajgarhia, Partner, Bahuguna Law Associates, said, “This is particularly relevant in cases where an earlier settlement attempt was unsuccessful, but circumstances have changed during the proceedings.”

Further, this could help SEBI secure earlier resolutions and recover dues in matters that are otherwise tied up in appeals, Rajgarhia said. SEBI's annual report shows ₹84,962.7 crore across 310 recovery cases is tied up in court-appointed committees, parallel proceedings, court stays or liquidation.

The proposed fast-track process for cases up to ₹10 lakh and removal of the addi-

tional 20 per cent charge for multiple proceedings are also expected to speed up case resolution.

Alay Razvi, Managing Partner, Accord Juris, however, said the pipeline will not automatically start shrinking. “Settlement will require consent, regulatory approval and consideration of investor interests. Cases involving fraud, manipulation, systemic harm, unresolved questions of law or the need for a public precedent may remain unsuitable.”

SEBI has suggested a simpler calculation, clearer treatment of defaults and lower additional charges for refiling withdrawn applications. “The main problem was that settlement amounts were often too high due to rigid multipliers, counting the same default multiple times, and adding excessive surcharges,” said Diviyi Chadha, Partner, Singhania & Co.

SEBI collected ₹109.8 crore in settlement charges and ₹11.3 crore in disgorgement during FY26.

BROKER'S CALL.

HDFC Securities

CENTURY PLYBOARDS (BUY)

Target: ₹990
CMP: ₹751.05
We interacted with Century Plyboards India management. The company indicated that following a strong Q1, demand momentum has remained healthy, with July emerging as the best month so far. Channel inventories exited Q1 at normalised levels. The management highlighted that it has onboarded Aamir Khan for advertising campaign, which will step up company advertisement spending. While this is expected to enhance brand visibility and support growth, the elevated ad spend intensity will exert some near-term pressure on margins. Consequently, plywood margins are unlikely to sustain at the high level seen in Q1 FY27, owing to increased marketing spends. In ply, capacity expansions underway to move to fully inhouse manufacturing. Currently, ply outsourcing has been reduced to single digit in overall mix. We like Century's strong franchise (pan-India distribution, aggressive marketing and a wide range of SKUs) and leadership presence in most wood panel segments. The company is consistently demonstrating strong execution across segments and gaining market share. With meaningful incremental plywood capacity coming onstream, we expect Century to continue outperforming peers and further consolidate its market-leading position. Considering the expected increase in advertisement spending, we trim our FY27E APAT by 4 per cent, while we maintain our FY28/29E estimates. We maintain BUY and value the stock at 40x September 2028E EPS, arriving at a target price of ₹990/share.

Systematix Institutional

PATANJALI FOODS (BUY)

Target: ₹580
CMP: ₹352.05
Patanjali Foods' management reiterated their FY27 guidance despite inflationary challenges while cautioning on El Nino and its likely impact on rural demand/income trends, on the Q127 earnings call. The company took calibrated price hikes across categories in response to sharp cost-inflation across edible oils, crude-linked inputs, packaging, freight and logistics – pricing drove a major part of its sales' expansions in edible oils and growth normalisation in foods. It highlighted strong expansion in biscuits, with good growth in ₹5/10 packs along with positive traction in premium biscuits such as almond cookies. The management indicated that in edible oils, the company carries long positions and thereby benefits from the inflation – Q1 operating margin expanded 340 bps. The company sees persistent inflation here with supply hiccups and higher transportation costs. However, margins in the FMCG (foods, HPC) businesses contracted on account of the sharp input-cost inflation, with the margin pressure especially pronounced in staples. The management reaffirmed FMCG FY27 EBITDA growth guidance of 12-15 per cent. We raise our FY27E-28E estimates by 3-4 per cent to factor in the Q1 operating beat in edible oils. We introduce FY29E estimates, and build FY26-29E revenue/EPS CAGR of 10 per cent/23 per cent. We maintain BUY rating, roll forward valuation to June-2028E (from March-2028E) and value the stock at P/E of 30x, to arrive at a revised TP of ₹580 (from ₹600).

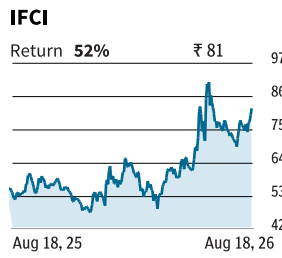
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

IFCI (₹81.41): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for IFCI. The stock has surged over 6 per cent so far this week. The 3 per cent rise on Tuesday has taken the share price well above a key resistance level of ₹79. It also confirms an inverted head and shoulder pattern. This is a bullish pattern. The neckline support of this pattern is at ₹79 which can limit the downside now. IFCI share price can go up to ₹92 and even ₹95 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy IFCI shares now at ₹81. Accumulate on dips at ₹80. Keep the stop-loss at ₹74. Trail the



stop-loss up to ₹84 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹87. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹86 and ₹90 when the share price goes up to ₹89 and ₹92 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹94.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24216 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24200	24050	24270	24340	Go short on a break below 24200. Keep the stop-loss at 24220	
₹723 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
722	718	727	730	Take fresh shorts below 722. Keep the stop-loss at 723	
₹1114 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1110	1080	1130	1150	Go short only below 1110. Keep the stop-loss at 1115	
₹270 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
266	262	272	275	Go short now and at 271. Keep the stop-loss at 273	
₹239 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
237	235	241	244	Stuck inside a range. Avoid trading this stock now	
₹1320 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1310	1300	1330	1350	Go long only above 1330. Keep the stop-loss at 1325	
₹1054 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1050	1030	1065	1085	Take fresh shorts below 1050 with a stop-loss at 1055	
₹2282 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2220	2180	2300	2330	Go short now and at 2295. Stop-loss can be kept at 2310	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 132.75 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Axis Bank	1243.00	9.85	13.84	3.23	
Reliance Ind	1322.00	8.86	20.29	8.08	
M&M	3421.50	6.07	21.02	2.76	
Bajaj Finance	1094.30	2.58	33.00	2.65	
Grasim Ind	3278.70	2.33	19.61	1.12	
PowerGrid Corp	268.00	1.83	15.68	1.10	
Max Healthcare	1014.40	1.74	67.74	0.68	
ONGC	239.50	0.86	6.73	0.84	
Bajaj Finserve	2011.20	0.78	15.60	1.05	
NTPC	3371.10	0.39	11.14	1.45	
Cipla	1431.10	0.05	34.45	0.73	
Apollo Hosp	8817.00	-0.19	58.37	0.82	
Trent Ltd.	2942.10	-0.28	86.45	0.89	
Adani Enter	3002.50	-0.30	51.99	0.78	
Bharat Elec	412.00	-0.35	48.99	1.33	
Coal India	406.90	-0.81	8.04	0.88	
Tata Steel	185.50	-0.90	20.56	1.39	
Eicher Motors	8018.50	-0.95	38.13	1.00	
HDFC Life	538.25	-1.12	58.81	0.52	
NestleIndia	1462.50	-1.18	74.00	0.95	
SBI Life	1778.00	-1.22	68.58	0.72	
Bajaj Auto	11607.00	-1.36	28.08	1.16	
Adani Ports	1682.40	-1.39	29.54	1.21	
TataConsumerProduct	1061.60	-1.57	63.97	0.63	
Sun Pharma	1875.10	-1.60	37.13	1.80	
Dr Reddys Lab	1178.80	-1.76	30.91	0.65	
Titan	5048.60	-1.80	77.81	1.89	
Maruti Suzuki	13691.00	-1.97	30.03	1.62	
JSW Steel	1267.60	-2.09	11.07	1.08	
Wipro	178.06	-2.27	13.27	0.44	
Tech Mahindra	1592.00	-2.50	30.22	0.91	
Hindalco	1041.60	-2.63	14.27	1.36	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5220.00	-2.75	0.00	1.07	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	245.80	-2.83	78.54	0.73	
Eternal Ltd.	315.90	-3.32	704.05	2.07	
Tata Motors PV	322.10	-3.38	0.38	0.61	
Hind Unilever	2035.00	-3.88	45.56	1.63	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1108.40	-4.16	23.04	1.40	
UltraTech Cement	1149.00	-4.71	39.53	1.23	
ICIICI Bank	1412.00	-5.17	16.95	9.15	
L&T	4064.30	-5.73	28.49	4.30	
Asian Paints	2628.40	-5.82	52.12	1.08	
HCL Tech	1298.00	-6.22	20.20	1.24	
ITC	270.00	-6.42	16.76	2.35	
State Bank	1053.00	-7.41	10.84	3.94	
TCS	2280.00	-7.41	16.48	2.11	
Kotak Bank	387.65	-8.12	19.00	2.58	
Infosys	1115.00	-19.08	14.92	5.34	
HDFC Bank	2008.00	-13.49	13.49	10.02	
Bharti Airtel	1534.20	-23.32	32.37	5.32	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 165.20 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Bosch	48730.00	44.37	60.82	1.65	
Divis Lab	8588.00	39.33	77.94	4.27	
Torrent Pharma	4971.00	30.27	87.70	2.85	
Sanvardmothersoninternatl	170.40	30.04	39.48	2.54	
Adani Power	205.58	24.36	27.28	3.34	
Hindustanaeronautics	5099.00	22.05	36.58	3.78	
Varun Beverages	439.30	21.66	43.58	2.3	
Solar Industries	20280.00	19.82	89.50	1.93	
Adani Energy Solutions	1603.00	13.27	62.31	2.06	
Gail (India)	173.50	10.97	115.6	1.83	
Adani Gas Cv	474.65	7.59	41.48	3.85	
Three Cement	24725.00	7.38	54.53	1.29	
Tata Capital	363.15	5.71	28.14	2.11	
Pdiddint	1674.00	4.50	63.67	2.03	
Mazagon Dock	1528.00	3.82	36.57	0.77	
Svenson	3957.00	3.60	97.00	1.37	
Godrej Consumer	931.00	3.50	49.78	1.46	
Muthbin	2884.00	1.75	10.14	1.22	
Hdfc Airc	2525.00	1.18	36.77	2.01	
Power Finance	374.45	0.21	36.7	2.13	
Hyundai Motor India	2186.00	-1.66	35.88	1.22	
Tata Power	381.00	-2.42	23.16	2.49	
Indian Hotels Co.	119.00	-2.55	44.33	2.47	
Siemens Energy India	3793.20	-2.11	86.00	1.24	
Ambuja Cements	412.40	-5.16	19.76	1.01	
Ujjain Steel	393.50	-5.44	3.56	1.65	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	86.11	-4.99	15.65	0.68	
Avenuesuper	3981.00	-6.56	84.92	2.51	
Punjab Nat Bank	116.50	-8.21	6.05	1.57	
Indian Oilcorp	137.80	-8.79	5.45	2.01	
Britannia Ind	5495.00	-8.90	50.71	2.53	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	694.75	-9.17	113.75	2.40	
Reliance	886.25	-9.79	37.07	1.89	
Hydrosulfences	1115.69	-11.56	24.81	1.09	
Hindus Zinc	558.00	-13.28	13.81	1.05	
Bank Of Baroda	244.00	-13.75	6.86	1.77	
Jindal Steel	110.50	-15.72	41.48	1.60	
Bajaj Holdings	11254.00	-15.73	13.93	1.91	
Abb India	7546.00	-17.39	102.82	1.55	
Union Bank	185.00	-18.09	6.86	1.40	
Adani Energy	139.10	-19.10	100.40	1.70	
Anara Bank	129.10	-19.53	5.39	1.71	
Tcs Motor Comp.	4356.80	-19.87	57.48	4.00	
United Spirits	1528.00	-20.69	65.57	1.76	
Cholamandalamin&fin	1660.00	-21.00	27.69	3.16	
Macrotech	264.00	-28.09	6.18	1.75	
Vedodont Developers	121.10	-34.59	29.31	1.31	
Limintree	4562.20	-37.19	26.04	1.66	
Ravi	37.30	-37.40	7.98	2.46	
Cummins India	5550.00	-39.26	62.65	2.83	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

President’s nod for two bills passed on August 10

New Delhi: President Droupadi Murmu has given her assent to the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Act, 2026, and another law to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act of 2007. The Bills were passed by Parliament on August 10. The Acts have received the assent of the President on August 17, the Ministry of Law said in a gazette notification. **PII**

India adds minimum import price on float glass

New Delhi: India has imposed a minimum import price of ₹34,000 per tonne on clear float glass for one year, a move that could benefit domestic producers, including Saint-Gobain and Asahi India, by curbing lower-priced imports. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade, in a notification dated August 18, changed the import policy for clear float glass of 4-12 mm thickness. Imports priced at or above ₹34,000 per tonne on a CIF basis will continue to be permitted, while shipments below the threshold will face the new restriction. **PII**

PM CARES fund rises to ₹8,453 crore in 2024-25, 175% jump in five years

Our Bureau New Delhi

Total receipts, including refund and interest, under the Prime Minister’s Citizen Assistance and Relief in Emergency Situations (PM CARES) fund has risen from ₹3,076.62 crore in 2019-20, when it was launched, to ₹8,452.95 crore in 2024-25, including fixed deposit worth ₹6,641.57 crore from past years. The government published a one-page financial statement of audited accounts for 2024-25 without disclosing details, which was criticised by RTI activists. According to the audited statement of account of the PM CARES fund for FY25, signed by its Secretary Subhashish Panda and three other officials, as well as Tejas Parikh, partner of the Mumbai-based chartered accountancy firm KKC & Asso-

FM urges banks to launch month-long Gen-Z focused campaign from Oct 2

NEW INITIATIVE. ‘Improve agri finance design, keeping in mind Prime Minister’s Shakti of Sapt Dhara vision’

Shishir Sinha New Delhi

With youth movements on the rise, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman called upon public sector banks (PSBs) to consider launching a month-long campaign on October 2 aimed at addressing the financial needs for ‘young citizens above the age of 16 years’. She also asked banks to improve the design of agriculture finance, keeping in mind the Prime Minister’s vision of Shakti of Sapt Dhara (Strength of Seven streams). Addressing the valedictory session of the two-day PSB Confluence 2026, she said banking is also the foundational infrastructure of a person’s livelihood journey. Hence, financial capability should develop seamlessly alongside adulthood, not as a reactive, stressful adjustment upon starting one’s first professional engagement. Engaging them early,



BANKING FOR ALL. Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addressing the two-day ‘PSB Confluence 2026’ **PII**

therefore, presents both an important responsibility and a significant opportunity for our banks.

OUTREACH TO YOUTH

“I would like PSBs to consider launching a focused, month-long ‘Banking for Youth’ campaign commencing October 2, with outreach to young citizens above 16 years of age,” she said.

Banks could take engagement to young people rather than wait for them to come to branches. Colleges, universities, skill-building insti-

tutions and other campuses can become important touchpoints for the campaign through account-opening initiatives, financial awareness and direct interaction.

Dedicated youth banking spaces such as ‘Yuva Kiosks’ or *Yuva Banking Mitra* could also be created at bank branches, where a dedicated employee could help them navigate their financial journey. “Equal emphasis should be given to building awareness of the formal credit ecosystem, including credit scores, various bank credit products and government

credit schemes. This will enable youth to easily access finance for their future entrepreneurial journey,” she said, adding that banks should sensitise youth about the importance of maintaining good credit scores and history. “Banks could also complement their banking propositions with lifestyle-linked benefits including coupons/vouchers for fitness centres, yoga centres and credible mental wellness platforms,” Sitharaman said.

Young Indians have grown up with smartphones. Therefore, “Indian Banks Association (IBA) could also explore launching a web- and mobile-friendly portal dedicated to banking awareness for youth,” she said.

At the same time, IBA, in coordination with stakeholders, PSBs and DFS, could think of developing this portal as a single point where young people can understand banking services and financial opportunities suited to their needs and connect with

the appropriate banking services. The portal can guide them to the nearest PSB branch, where they can open a Basic Savings Bank Deposit Account with no banking charges, interact with officials and access appropriate banking services.

AGRI FINANCING

Talking about priority sector lending, Sitharaman recalled the Prime Minister’s vision of ‘Sapt Dhara’ where he placed great emphasis on agriculture. “Banks must translate this vision into appropriately designed and targeted agricultural financing. They must substantially expand credit to farmers growing pulses and oilseeds, which will reduce India’s dependence on imports and help improve soil health and bring *Atmanirbharta*,” she said, adding that this effort should be aligned with the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana, particularly in the districts covered under the scheme.

Trump says SoH now open, contradicts Tehran

Reuters Dubai/ Washington

US President Donald Trump on Tuesday said no talks were taking place with Iran and none were scheduled, and insisted that the Strait of Hormuz was open, contradicting an earlier Iranian assertion that the critical waterway remained shut.

The receding prospects of a deal to end the nearly six-month conflict drove up oil prices again on Tuesday, while stock markets sagged and borrowing costs for major economies including the US hit multi-decade highs, amid concerns about the long-term inflationary and fiscal impact of the crisis.

‘CEASEFIRE EXPIRED’

A temporary ceasefire agreement expired on Monday and a senior Iranian official told *Reuters* that his country was moving to a “fully offensive” military posture due to the

diplomatic stalemate, though there were no reports of fresh strikes by either side on Tuesday.

“There are no talks or conversations going on, or scheduled, with the Islamic Republic of Iran,” Trump said in a post on Truth Social on Tuesday.

“The Naval Blockade remains in full force and effect. The Strait is open and operating. All water mines have been removed or detonated,” he added.

On Monday, Jared Kushner, Trump’s son-in-law and special envoy, had sounded an optimistic note, saying talks with Iran were still under way and were “probably more robust” than they had ever been.

Despite Trump’s typically ebullient remarks about the situation in the Gulf, preliminary shipping data on Tuesday showed ship crossings via the Strait of Hormuz were still in single-digits on Monday.

Domestic donations received in FY24 stood at ₹681.81 crore, while foreign donations totalled ₹1.13 crore

ciates LLP, closing balance on March 31, 2025, was ₹8,452.07 crore, up 18 per cent from ₹7,173.03 crore a year earlier.

The fund spent ₹87.85 lakh on PM CARES for Children Scheme during 2024-25, sharply down from ₹15.38 crore in 2023-24.

Domestic donations received in fiscal year 2023-24 stood at ₹681.81 crore, while foreign donations totalled ₹1.13 crore. In 2024-25, domestic donations worth ₹479.05 crore and foreign donations of ₹92.83 lakh were received, both lower than a year before.

IT Dept launches verification of 394 entities and 36 professionals for suspicious forex remittances

Our Bureau New Delhi

The Income Tax Department on Tuesday said it is verifying 394 entities and 36 professionals for suspicious foreign exchange remittance.

The department said it had launched a nationwide detailed verification exercise to verify suspicious foreign remittances, focussing on shell entities, the persons behind them and the professionals who have issued Form 15CB certificates.

About 117 entities located in districts along the country’s land borders and remitting significant amounts of money abroad have also been covered in the exercise.

This entire action was based on data related with remittance of large amounts of foreign exchange over the last three years.

A nationwide network of entities engaged in remitting funds abroad was uncovered during a search operation conducted on a group of fictitious charitable trusts involved in providing accommodation entries against bogus donations/contributions.

GROUND VERIFICATION

“Preliminary ground verification revealed that the entities making these remittances were either non-filers or were filing income-tax returns showing very small turnovers,” the department

said. Further, the turnovers had no apparent correlation with the large amounts of money being remitted abroad. They also did not appear to match the stated purpose of the remittances, such as payment for freight, import of software, or import of consulting services.

Ground-level intelligence also revealed that these entities were not actually operating from the addresses declared by them, it said.

Further analysis of the data also revealed that many Form 15CB certificates were issued by a relatively-small group of professionals. According to the department, the remitted funds were also received by a clustered group of entities.

Form 15CB, read with Rule 37BB of the Income-tax Rules, 1962 (corresponding to Form 146 read with Rule 220 of the Income-tax Rules, 2026), requires the accountant certifying a foreign remittance to verify its taxability with reference to the books of account and other relevant documents.

However, “the findings raise concerns about whether adequate due diligence was carried out by the accountants before issuing these certificates,” the department said.

It emphasised that accountants issuing certificates in Form 15CB/Form 146 are expected to exercise due care, diligence and professional judgment.

India-Israel FTA talks entering market-access phase

Amiti Sen New Delhi

India-Israel free trade agreement (FTA) negotiations, revived last year after years of intermittent discussions, are gathering momentum as both sides prepare to enter the crucial market-access phase, sources said.

Following the second round of talks in July, New Delhi is consulting domestic industry to finalise its offer ahead of the third round, when the two countries are expected to exchange market-access proposals.

“The request list for market access has been exchanged. Israel has sought market access in various



products and discussions are on with the Indian industry on the possible offers India can make. It is important to protect the interests of the domestic economy, so the inputs are crucial,” a person tracking the matter told *businessline*.

Total merchandise trade between India and Israel remains modest at \$3.93 billion in FY26, with India’s exports at about \$2.25 billion

and imports at around \$1.68 billion.

NICHE SEGMENTS

India exports cut and polished gems and jewellery, pharmaceuticals, chemicals, rice, aircraft parts, textiles and machinery, while imports include diamonds, chemicals, integrated circuits, machinery and electronics.

Trade research body Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) said, in a report last month, that an FTA with Israel is unlikely to sharply increase goods trade, given the country’s high-income, technology-driven market of fewer than 10 million people. This limits demand for mass-market exports such as tex-

tiles, automobiles and general engineering goods.

In sectors where India is competitive, including agriculture, generics, steel and chemicals, Israel is either self-sufficient, has stringent quality requirements, or already offers tariff preferences to partners such as the EU and the US. “Bilateral trade remains concentrated in niche categories such as diamonds, rice and ceramic tiles,” GTRI said.

The greater value of the FTA could lie in strategic co-operation in defence manufacturing, electronics, semiconductors, water and irrigation technology, precision agriculture, cybersecurity and frontier research and development, it added.



Natural Capsules Limited
CIN NO. L85110KA1993PLC014742
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Website: www.naturalcapsules.com
E-mail: info@naturalcapsules.com, Contact:080-26561562



Notice

This is to inform you that Extraordinary General Meeting (“EGM”) of the members of the Natural Capsules Limited will be held on Wednesday, September 09, 2026 at 12:00 PM through Video Conferencing (“VC”) / Other Audio Visual Means (“OAVM”) at the registered office of the Company at Trident Tower, 4th Floor, No. 23, 100 Feet Road, Jayanagar 2nd Block, Bangalore-560011, in accordance with General Circular No: 14/2020, 17/2020, 20/2020, 02/2021, 02/2022, 10/2022, 09/23 dated April 08, 2020, April 13, 2020, May 05, 2020, January 13, 2021, May 05, 2022 and December 28, 2022, September 25, 2023 respectively read with General Circular No. 09/24 dated September 19, 2024 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (Collectively “MCA Circulars”) and Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-POD-2/P/CI/RZ-20/2024/133 dated October 03, 2024 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”) and in compliance with the applicable provision of the Companies Act, 2013 and SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended, to transact businesses as set out in the Notice of EGM are available on the website of the Company at www.naturalcapsules.com and on the website of the Stock Exchange(s) at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com. In terms of the aforesaid Circulars, the electronic dispatch of Notice to members has been completed on August 18, 2026. Additionally, in accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, The Company is also sending a letter to shareholders, whose e-mail IDs are not registered with the Company/RTA/DP, providing the web-link of Company’s Website from where the Notice can be accessed. The copy of the Notice of EGM is also available on the Company’s Website www.naturalcapsules.com and on the website of NSDL (Agency for providing the Remote E-Voting facility) at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

In compliance with the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 and rules made thereunder read with Regulation 22 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, The Company is providing all its members to facility to cast their vote electronically on all the resolutions set out in the Notice of EGM. For this purpose, the Company has availed facility for voting through electronic means from NSDL available at www.evoting.nsdl.com. The Company has appointed Mr. Deepak Sachu representing M/s. Deepak Sachu Company Secretaries, Practicing Company Secretary as the Scrutinizer for e-voting process. The remote e-voting process period will commence from September 04, 2026 (09:00 AM) to September 08, 2026 (05:00 PM). During this period, members hold shares on cut-off date, i.e. Wednesday, September 02, 2026 may cast their vote electronically. The e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter. Members who acquire shares after sending notice through electronic means and hold(s) share(s) as of the cut-off date, i.e. September 02, 2026 may obtain the USER ID and Password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in and company.sec@naturalcapsules.com. However, if the person is already registered with NSDL for remote e-voting then you may use existing USER ID and Password and cast your vote.

The facility for e-voting will also be made available during the EGM and those members present in the EGM through VC/OAVM who have not cast their vote on the resolution through remote e-voting and/or otherwise not barred from doing so shall be eligible to vote through remote e-voting system at the EGM.

Members who don’t have USER ID or Password for e-voting and attending the EGM through VC/OAVM or forgotten USER ID or Password may retrieve the same by following the remote e-voting instructions given in the Notice of EGM. Further members can also use the OTP based login for logging into the e-voting system of NSDL.

The attendance of the members attending the EGM through VC/OAVM will be counted for the purpose of ascertaining the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.

Process of Registering Email Address:

Members who have not registered with the Depository(ies)/Company/RTA so far are requested to register/update their email addresses in the following manner:

1. In case shares are held in physical mode, members are requested to register the same by submitting duly filled in Form ISR-1 along with supporting documents to RTA at: investors@cameindia.com & company.sec@naturalcapsules.com.

2. In case shares are held in demat mode, please provide DPID-C-LID (16-digit DPID + CLID or 16-digit beneficiary ID), Name, client master or copy of Consolidated Account statement, PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) to company.sec@naturalcapsules.com.

Alternatively, member may send an e-mail request to evoting@nsdl.co.in for obtaining User ID and Password by providing the details mentioned in Point (1) or (2) as the case may be.

In case of any assistance, Members may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for shareholders at www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on toll free no: 1800-222-990 and 1800 22 44 30 or send a request to Mr. Falguni Chakraborty at: evoting@nsdl.co.in. Members are requested to contact Ms. Gomathi C of Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Registrar and Share Transfer Agents for any grievances related to e-voting by writing to them at gomathi@cameoindia.com or call them on 044-40020728 between 10:00 AM to 05:00 PM.

For Natural Capsules Limited
Sd/-
Place: Bangalore
Date: August 19, 2026
Akshay Dutta
Company Secretary

PM to inaugurate 5th Semicon India on Sept 17

S Ronendra Singh New Delhi



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the fifth edition of Semicon India 2026 on September 17, a mega-event that is set to bring together global semiconductor industry leaders, government officials, State representatives and sector experts as India builds on the momentum of its growing semiconductor ecosystem.

The three-day event, to be held between September 17 and 19 in New Delhi, is being organised under the theme ‘Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem’, S Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), told reporters here.

“The event is proposed to be inaugurated by the Prime Minister on September 17, and we believe it will once again reiterate the commitment that the government has for the semiconductor sector,” he added.

The event comes at a time when India’s semiconductor push is gaining pace under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) and the Semicon India programme. The ISM is in its second stage right now.

It is pertinent to mention that while 12 projects have been approved under ISM 1.0 — three of which have already started commercial production and two/three more are expected to follow suit by the calendar year-end — the Cabinet recently approved the ISM 2.0, aimed at accelerating the development of a robust and resilient semiconductor ecosystem.

“The conference will have a roundtable which will be chaired by the PM, and that will take place a day before September 17, with global CEOs,” Amitesh Kumar Sinha, Additional Secretary, MeitY, and CEO, ISM, said at a curtain-raiser briefing.

However, both the senior officials of MeitY declined to disclose any prominent global CEOs who are expected at the event. Countries including Japan, Korea, Singapore, Germany and the

During the AI Impact Summit in February this year, India formally joined the ‘Pax Silica’ coalition

Netherlands are expected to participate.

The US, which has led international efforts on ‘Pax Silica’ for resilient supply chains in semiconductors, artificial intelligence (AI) and critical minerals, is also expected to be present at the event.

PAX SILICA COALITION

During the AI Impact Summit in February this year, India formally joined the ‘Pax Silica’ coalition, marking a significant milestone in strengthening of strategic technology and supply chain cooperation between New Delhi and Washington. The government is also supporting semiconductor research, innovation and design by providing design tools to more than 332 academic institutes and 105 start-ups.

Under the Design-Linked Incentive scheme also, 24 start-ups have been approved to work on critical applications. These initiatives are aimed at developing a holistic semiconductor ecosystem in India and advancing the government’s Aatmanirbhar Bharat vision, the MeitY said.

The details of Semicon India 2026 were announced by ISM, the MeitY and SEMI, the industry association promoting the semiconductor sector.



TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
Sahar Receiving Station, (Near Hotel Leela, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India)
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest from eligible parties for “Outline Agreement for 2 years for Structural Painting Works at External Cold Handling System (ECHS), Mundra Thermal Power Station, Gujarat (Tender Ref. No.: CC27PMR007)”

For details of pre-qualification requirements, purchasing of tender document, bid security, etc., please visit Tender section of our website (**URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing>**). Eligible parties willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee on or before **28th August 2026**.



Malabar Regional Co-operative Milk Producers’ Union Ltd.
Malappuram Dairy & Milk Powder Plant
Enduser: Dairy/Commercial/Industrial/Export
No. MPM/ENG/2026-27
18.08.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders are invited from eligible bidders for the following purchase.

Item	Closing Date	Source of Bid Documents
Tender for the Supply of PP laminated Kraft Paper bag with LD liner for Milk Powder at Malappuram Dairy-E-tender id: 2026_KCMMF_861839_2	02.09.2026 4.00 PM	www.etenders. kerala.gov.in
Tender for the Supply of Printed Laminated Four Layer Film for Dairy Whitter at Malappuram Dairy, E-tender id: 2026_KCMMF_861819_2	02.09.2026 9.00 AM	

For further enquiries, contact: 9037419987 Malappuram Dairy, MRCMPU Ltd. **Dairy Manager**



TATA POWER
(Contracts Department)
Jojobera Generation Plant, RAHARGORAH, JAMSHEDPUR-831016, Jharkhand

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTERES

The **Tata Power Company Limited** invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the package Name

S.No.	Tender Description	Ref No
1	Three Year Contract For Services for Chemical Lab Operation-PH-6 (Inside TataSteel)	CC27UAJOJO-7
2	Corrigendum- Hiring of Bus Service(Big 44 AC) for 5 Years (Last Due Date-27th June26)	CC27UAJOJO-6

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit Tender section of our website (**URL: <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>**). Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **30th Aug’26**.



TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The **Tata Power Company Limited** invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai.

Secure Remote Access Solution for OT Network. (RFQ No.: 4100069756)

For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website **<https://www.tatapower.com/tender>**. Interested bidders to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter along with Complete Bid Document by **10.09.2026, 03.00 PM**.

Also, all future corrigendum/s (if any), to the above tender will be informed on website **<https://www.tatapower.com>** only.

QUICKLY.

Sundaram Home Fin to expand emerging biz in AP



Chennai: Sundaram Home Finance is targeting to treble disbursements in the emerging business (EB) segment in Andhra Pradesh this year. The company, which disbursed ₹50 crore in Andhra Pradesh in this segment in FY26, is now targeting disbursements of ₹150 crore this year. The company currently has around 10 EB branches in Andhra, and is now looking to double its branch network to 20 this year, with most of the expansion set to take place in smaller towns in the State. As a first step of this current expansion, the company recently opened a branch in Chittoor. The housing finance company is planning to hire around 60 people in Andhra Pradesh for the EB segment to drive its growth in the State. “In the first year of our EB launch in Andhra Pradesh, we have seen consistent growth across all our branches,” said D Lakshminarayanan, Managing Director, Sundaram Home Finance. **OUR BUREAU**

CCI nod for Prudential to acquire Bharti Life stake

New Delhi: Fair trade regulator Competition Commission of India on Tuesday cleared the proposal of Prudential Corporation Holdings, an arm of UK-based financial giant Prudential, to acquire a stake in Bharti Life Insurance Company. “The combination envisages the acquisition of certain equity shareholding in Bharti Life Insurance Company Ltd (target) by Prudential Corporation Holdings Ltd (acquirer),” said CCI. **¶¶**

L&T Finance expects gold loan biz to contribute over 10% to total loan book in the next five years

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

L&T Finance Ltd, which entered the gold loan business last year, expects the gold loan segment to contribute more than 10 per cent to its total loan book over the next five years, compared with around 3 per cent at present. In order to scale up the gold loan business, the NBFC is planning to set up at least 500 new branches each year till 2031. “I will not be surprised if the gold loan portfolio will be upward of 10 per cent of the loan book in 2031. I do not see any challenges happening,” L&T Finance Chief Operating Officer Raju Dodti told *businessline*. L&T Finance entered the gold loan business through the acquisition of the gold loan business of Paul Merchants Finance (PMFL), a

‘Cash demand remains strong in India despite digital payments’

CRITICAL ROLE. Maintaining public confidence in cash core responsibility of RBI, says Deputy Governor Murmu

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Despite the rapid growth of digital payments, cash continues to play a critical role in India’s economy, especially in rural- and semi-urban regions among low-income households, senior citizens and small businesses, said Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Deputy Governor Shirish Chandra Murmu at the Global Cash Management 2026 conference organised by Bank Indonesia in Jakarta. Addressing central bankers from across the world, Murmu highlighted India’s “cash paradox”. He



The country has around 176 billion banknotes in circulation, and the RBI produces 28-30 billion banknotes annually

SHIRISH CHANDRA MURMU
RBI Deputy Governor



noted that currency in circulation continues to grow at double-digit rates despite a decline in cash’s share of individual transactions due to increasing digital payment

adoption. He underscored the massive scale of India’s currency management operations, revealing that the country currently has around 176 billion bank-

notes in circulation. The RBI produces 28-30 billion banknotes annually and withdraws about 21 billion soiled notes every year. The Deputy Governor stressed that maintaining public confidence in cash remains a core responsibility of the central bank. He pointed to the RBI’s Clean Note Policy, under which old and unfit currency notes are regularly removed and replaced with good quality banknotes. Murmu also highlighted India’s self-reliance in currency production, with banknote paper mills, printing presses and ink production units largely controlled by the RBI and the

Government of India.

CHALLENGES AHEAD Among the challenges ahead, he identified the difficulty of forecasting currency demand in an increasingly digital economy, improving note durability through technologies such as polymer notes and reducing the environmental footprint of the cash management cycle. Murmu said that while digital payments are expanding, cash continues to be a significant payment instrument, and ensuring its integrity through secure logistics and efficient distribution remains a key responsibility of the central bank.

PNB Housing Finance eyes higher-yielding segments, to launch micro housing finance

Our Bureau
Mumbai

PNB Housing Finance is seeking to change the composition of its loan book towards higher-yielding segments by rolling out micro housing finance in the current quarter and further expanding the affordable housing and emerging markets loan portfolios.

PNB LOAN BOOK As of June-end 2026, 59 per cent of the housing finance company’s ₹89,670 crore loan book comprised loans to the prime segment (loans above ₹35 lakh), with the rest being accounted for by the affordable housing (₹5-

35 lakh) and emerging markets (₹25 lakh) loan portfolios. Ajai Kumar Shukla, MD & CEO, said that even as the company’s loan book is expected to cross the ₹1 lakh crore in the current financial year, the composition of prime and affordable housing & emerging markets is likely to shift to 55:45 in the overall loan book. “We are already classified as an upper layer NBFC, and are following the applicable regulatory and compliance requirements. By FY28, we expect the loan book to be around ₹1.2 lakh crore or higher. Beyond that, reaching ₹2 lakh crore will be a journey. We expect to grow the loan book by around 18-20 per cent annually,” he



We are classified as an upper layer NBFC, and are following the applicable regulatory and compliance requirements

AJAI KUMAR SHUKLA
MD & CEO, PNB Housing Finance



said. Shukla observed that PNB Housing Finance had started purchasing portfolios through direct assignment (DA) transactions. “We completed a small transaction last quarter, purchasing around ₹146 crore of portfolios from four companies. These portfolios

were largely in the affordable housing segment. It is another avenue for building the loan book,” said Shukla.

KEY ADVANTAGE He emphasised that the key advantage in DA transactions is that there is no significant incremental operating

expenditure associated with sourcing the business. In an organic model, people, branches, market coverage and incentives are to source loans. Shukla observed that with a DA transaction, the HFC purchases an existing pool and books it directly, with the acquisition price effectively becoming the key cost consideration. “Over time, we are targeting DA to be approximately 2 per cent of the book. We are conservative because we already have a strong organic sourcing platform, with around 400 branches and a large team. DA is, therefore, an additional opportunity, rather than a replacement for organic growth,” he said.

After aircraft, ships & oilfield equipment, IFSCA moves to make GPU leasing a financial product at GIFT City

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Having enabled operating leases for aircraft, ships and oilfield equipment, the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) on Tuesday proposed allowing the leasing of graphics processing units (GPUs) and connected data centre equipment as a financial product at GIFT City in Gujarat. “As with aircraft and ship leasing, enabling GPU equipment leasing at this early stage of the global AI infrastructure expansion will help attract leasing activity to the IFSC, broaden its leasing ecosystem and position India as an early participant in this emerging market,” stated a IFSCA consultation paper, where the GIFT City regulator proposed notifying operating leases, including hybrids of operating and fin-



GIANT LEAP. India is preparing for a sharp increase in demand for AI computing capacity

ancial leases, of GPUs and connected data-centre equipment as a financial product under the IFSCA Act. The proposal comes as India prepares for a sharp increase in demand for AI computing capacity. IFSCA estimates that the deployment of 6,50,000-7,00,000 GPUs in Indian data centres over the next five years could create an invest-

Rupee approaches a key support level

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl research bureau

The rupee weakened over the past week, losing about 24 paise, or 0.25 per cent, against the dollar. The local currency faced pressure as foreign portfolio flows turned negative and crude oil prices continued to rise. According to NSDL data, FPIs registered net outflow of about \$207 million over the past week. Nevertheless, cumulative flows for August remains positive, with net inflow of about \$1.8 billion so

WEEKLY RUPEE VIEW.

far this month. Crude oil prices have emerged as a more significant headwind for the rupee. Brent crude futures have been rising over the last two weeks. After gaining close to 6 per cent last week, Brent crude is up another 2.5 per cent so far this week and is currently trading around \$91/barrel. A sustained rise in crude prices is negative for the rupee as it increases India’s import bill and demand for dollars. The recent reversal in foreign flows, although modest, also takes away some of the support that the local currency had seen earlier this month. Therefore, with crude oil prices firming and foreign flows turning marginally negative, the near-term fundamental backdrop has become less supportive for the rupee.

CHART The rupee has been on a decline since August 5. Currently at 95.68, the price action indicates that the decline is likely to continue. That said, there is support ahead at 95.8. If this can help

The dollar index, which saw a drop from 101.50 to 99.80 towards the end of July, has been oscillating between 99.40 and 100 since the beginning of this month

in a rebound, the local currency can recover to 95.25 or even to 95. However, if the rupee breaches the base at 95.80, it can extend the decline to 96.2, or even to 96.5. Hence, the next leg of move hinges on the support at 95.8.

DOLLAR INDEX Meanwhile, after witnessing a downtrend, the dollar seems to be stabilising. That is, the dollar index, which saw a drop from 101.5 to 99.8 towards the end of July, has been oscillating between 99.4 and 100 since the beginning of this month. Therefore, only a clear breakout of the range of 99.4-100 will determine the next leg of trend. A breakout of 100 can lead to the dollar gaining traction, possibly leading to a quick uptick to 100.5. Instead, if the support at 99.4 is breached, it will confirm a bear flag pattern, a strong indication of continuation of the downtrend. In that case, the dollar index can be dragged to 98 or even to 97.5.

OUTLOOK The rupee is at a crucial juncture, with 95.8 likely to determine the next move. While a breach of this level can extend the decline towards 96.5, a weaker dollar could provide room for a recovery towards 95.

Rising vet bill fuels demand for pet insurance

Insurance policies offer sum insured options ranging from ₹10,000 to ₹15 lakh

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

As pets increasingly become an integral part of the family, concerns about their health and rising costs of veterinary care are driving the demand for insurance policies. Insurers say interest in pet insurance has been steadily gaining momentum, driven by greater awareness of veterinary healthcare, rising treatment costs and changing lifestyles, particularly among nuclear families and DINK (dual income, no kids) households. “The demand for pet insurance has grown steadily and gained significant momentum in recent years,” Amarnath Saxena, Chief Technical Officer-Commercial, Bajaj General

Insurance, told *businessline*. The insurer has seen consistent growth in customer adoption since launching a pet insurance product in 2021. The growing cost of veterinary treatment is another factor encouraging pet owners to consider insurance. “Veterinary expenses, medicines and surgeries can be costly, especially when a pet needs sudden treatment. This is making pet owners think about how they would manage such expenses if something unexpected happens,” said Arti Mulik, Chief Technical Officer, Universal Sompo General Insurance. **SEES GOOD RESPONSE** Universal Sompo has seen good response to its pet assure product, she added.



The growing awareness is not confined to metropolitan centres where the demand for pet cover is witnessing speedy growth. “The demand is also not limited to larger cities. We are seeing more awareness in tier-2 and -3 cities as well,” said Mulik. Dogs continue to account for the largest share of pet insurance adoption, while cats are the second most insured category. Insurance for other pets such as birds

has not yet been initiated. According to industry data, pet insurance policies offer sum insured options ranging from ₹10,000 to ₹15 lakh, with a modular structure that allows pet owners to customise their protection by selecting different covers. They cover surgery expenses arising from accidents, illnesses and fractures. Pet owners can additionally opt for OPD coverage. **LEGAL LIABILITY** Beyond healthcare, the policy provides third-party liability protection for legal liability arising from bodily injury, property damage, sickness or death caused by the pet, along with admissible legal defence costs. Industry claims data indicate pet insurance is being used for both routine

healthcare and more expensive medical interventions. “A large share arises from routine healthcare needs covered under OPD benefits, such as veterinary consultations, diagnostic tests and minor treatments,” said Saxena. Despite the growing interest, insurers acknowledge that pet insurance remains a nascent category, and the opportunity, therefore, extends beyond selling policies. It is also about changing how pet owners prepare for healthcare costs. Industry experts peg the portfolio size around ₹40-50 crore. “My pet was diagnosed with renal issues and treated for a month, which cost me ₹1.5 lakh. I received ₹1.3 lakh from my insurer,” said AG Rao, who owns a Golden Retriever.

Preferred to expand into premium mushroom popcorn variants in India

Rohan Das
Chennai

Preferred Popcorn, a US-based company that supplies popcorn kernels, is looking to expand into the more premium ‘mushroom popcorn’ variants in India as gourmet popcorn culture gains ground. Mushroom variants are rounder, denser kernels that are suitable for gourmet popcorn flavours, such as caramel or cheese, as opposed to the regular butterfly variants. Speaking to *businessline*, Thomas Peace, Director of Sales at Preferred Popcorn, said: “Traditionally, over the last 10 years, we have been doing a lot of butterfly varieties. Now, we are starting to diversify more into these mushroom varieties, enabling us to sell to a different customer base in the gour-

met products space.” The expansion comes at a time when India’s popcorn industry is seeing increased premiumisation, with brands such as 4700BC building a market for gourmet, ready-to-eat popcorn with premium flavours and packaging. **SOURCING KERNELS** Preferred Popcorn currently operates in India through a partnership with Chennai-based Gourmet Popcornica, and supplies kernels in bulk to restaurants, retailers, movie theatres and commercial establishments. The kernels are sourced directly from Indian farmers, who cultivate it on 16 acres of land spread across nine States. While Preferred Popcorn exports kernels grown in its farms in Nebraska in mid-western US to over 70 countries, India is the only geo-

graphy where the company operates with a domestic partner and grows the kernels locally. “When our partners here first started importing from Preferred Popcorn, the only struggle was that there was a 55 per cent import duty. So, everything they were selling was getting marked up, which became pretty cost prohibitive for many cinemas. So, we thought maybe we could grow US style popcorn in India domestically,” he said. **GENETIC TECHNOLOGY** Peace added that while the firm earlier faced challenges, given India’s climatic conditions that are not ideal for popcorn cultivation, over the years, it has experimented with planting seasons and genetic technology to cultivate popcorn suitable for the country’s soil and weather conditions.

QUICKLY.

DSP Finance buys lending platform Volt Money

Mumbai: DSP Finance, the NBFC arm of the DSP Group, has acquired Salter Technologies (Volt Money), a digital platform for loans against financial assets, particularly loans against mutual funds for undisclosed amount. Volt Money, an early player in the digital LAMF market, enables customers to borrow against their mutual fund holdings seamlessly, with funds disbursed in five minutes. DSP Finance has over 1.8 lakh retail customers and a loan book of ₹4,000 crore. **OUR BUREAU**

Funschool gets Paw Patrol toy rights in India

Chennai: Toy manufacturer Funschool India has acquired the license to manufacture and distribute Paw Patrol merchandise and collectible toys across retail stores and online platforms. The new range of toys include Paw Patrol Basic Vehicle Chase, Marshall, Skye, Ryder, Rocky, Rubble, Rex, Everest, Tracker and Zuma. **OUR BUREAU**

Satcom witnessing remarkable phase of technological evolution: Experts

TECH LIFELINE. Stakeholders envision satcom as a vital tool for modernising agriculture, enhancing digital infra

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Satellite communication (satcom) is witnessing a remarkable phase of technological evolution with advances in smaller and more capable satellites, large constellations, software-defined systems, intelligent on-board processing and increasingly sophisticated antenna technologies continuously expanding what can be delivered from space, a senior official at NITI Aayog said on Tuesday.

“These developments are transforming satcom sector into more dynamic and intelligent communications infrastructure,” Abhay Karandikar, Member, NITI Aayog, said at the 10th edition of India Satcom 2026, organised by the Broadband India Forum (BIF) here.

According to the BIF, India has a digital connectivity



DIGITAL ACCESS. Satcom airwaves in rural areas can help provide good connectivity to private enterprises

opportunity worth ₹1 lakh crore at a conservative estimate, which can be largely achieved through satcom services.

“There are more than 50 crore people who are still unconnected, mostly in rural and remote parts of the country. Even if we consider low ARPU (average revenue per user) from these areas, the present opportunity is at least around ₹1 lakh crore per annum at present. These people are not connected be-

cause the terrestrial network has not reached them. They can be largely served by satcom services,” TV Ramachandran, President, BIF, said on the sidelines of the event here.

According to him, 60 to 70 per cent of the country's population depends on agriculture and at present there is no way of launching or reaching networks in a viable way to fields.

“But you can modernise agriculture and improve the

GOOD CONNECTIVITY
Ramachandran said satcom airwaves in rural areas can help provide good connectivity to private enterprises.

“If people want to set up a factory in a rural area, labour will be cheap and there are plenty of available people. These enterprises can utilise satcom connectivity in rural areas,” he said.

Speaking at the event, Department of Telecom Member (Finance) Manish Sinha also said the future of telecom networks is not just satellite versus terrestrial or telecom versus space, but an

integrated communication system which has fibre, mobile, wi-fi and satellite connectivity.

“The policy challenge is to build bridges between all these technologies. We have the market, talent, institutional capability, and we need to deploy all of it to ensure that there is a seamless relationship between all these technologies, and that together they help us to grow and strengthen the telecom infrastructure that we have around the country,” Sinha said.

He added that there is no doubt that satellites can contribute significantly to the digital infrastructure, support schools, healthcare, agriculture, logistics, aviation, maritime services, critical infrastructure and disaster management, while also extending connectivity to communities that conventional networks may find difficult to reach.

Sammaan Capital resolves 7-year-old legal issues

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Sammaan Capital appears to have finally emerged from a seven-year legal overhang after investigative agencies and court proceedings reaffirmed that the company is neither an accused nor under investigation in matters linked to its erstwhile promoter.

Following Tuesday's Supreme Court hearing, senior advocate Nalin Kohli, appearing for Sammaan Capital, said investigations by the Economic Offences Wing and the Central Bureau of Investigation had found no wrongdoing by the company.

According to Kohli, agency affidavits showed that loans extended by the company to entities named in a public interest litigation were repaid in full along with interest and the accounts were closed.

“There is no indication of any wrongdoing by Sammaan Capital. Whatever loans were given were duly received back with interest.

In fact, in one part of the investigation, Sammaan Capital has been viewed as a victim rather than a wrongdoer,” Kohli said.

The PIL had sought a probe into transactions involving former promoter Sameer Gehlaut and five corporate groups, including DLF, Vatika, AmeriCorp, Chordia Group and Reliance ADAG.

Investigators examined whether loans extended by the then Indiabulls Housing Finance, now Sammaan Capital, involved any irregularities.

LOAN RECOVERED
Kohli said around ₹8,000 crore of loans extended to these entities had been recovered, with the company receiving nearly ₹11,000 crore, including interest.

Kohli said the company had undergone a complete transformation in ownership and governance.

The Supreme Court also reiterated that it had not expressed any opinion on the merits of allegations against Sammaan Capital.

Share of freshers in IT workforce will rise in the AI age: Hexaware CEO

bl.interview

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

The IT industry appears to be a challenging field for freshers to enter in the age of AI, with companies increasingly relying on lateral hires as they battle AI-related costs. Despite these complexities, Hexaware's CEO R Srikrishna puts his faith in the younger workforce, arguing that while lacking in experience, the younger employees have a longer experience interacting and using AI. Srikrishna shares his expectations from

newcomers entering the workforce and explains the rationale behind offering multiple pricing models to customers to encourage spending.

Edited excerpts:

What is the objective of offering multiple pricing models to customers?

The first objective is to participate in token economics. The token cost is going to become a material part of IT budgets. We want to be in that line item of budget where we add value to our clients. We do not want to be a reseller. We want to participate in the token revenue and still optimise it for cli-

ents. That's the principle behind the models.

As you rethink pricing, how are you going about hiring freshers?

What is true is that the percentage of freshers in our hiring process has seen a reduction. My belief is it's temporary.

Our industry has been very good at commoditising and making factory out of scale creation. There was a hype period when we struggled to find talent but soon enough we created training factories and churned out masters.

That time will come for AI too. Younger talent is actually better in AI because they

In our own AI labs and in pure R&D, the average age is around 26 years. Our platform building and engineering teams are also full of very young people

R SRIKRISHNA
Hexaware's CEO

learn fast and many of them are AI-native as well. They are kids out of college, who have been using AI in schools for at least three years already. Though our customers understand this, they're



coming from the clients?

Much of it comes from clients. It has always been the case that they want more senior talent. In AI, that is even more true. But truer still is that younger talents are better at AI.

In our own AI labs and in pure R&D, the average age is around 26 years. Our platform building and engineering teams are also full of very young people.

How are you focusing on R&D in that sense?

What would take us months to build, we can do it in weeks. We are able to build a minimum viable product (MVP) in just eight weeks

and the first release in 12 weeks. That's the kind of speed at which we can build on the platform side. We have significant investments, disproportionate to our size. We will have to increase it further.

How are clients using AI considering legacy tech debt?

Historically, despite huge opportunity, customers don't spend money on tech because it is too time consuming, risky, and expensive. AI has changed that, and has made it more deterministic. So, customers are using AI for tech debt.

We are now seeing deals that are above \$10 billion in

tech debt remediation and in modernisation. The second issue of tech debt is ahead of us. Once Mythos becomes public, and cloud security starts being more widely used, the volume and velocity of vulnerability discovery is going to be staggering. One of the remediations for that is going to be necessarily tech debt elimination.

All these vulnerabilities are resident because of bad software, old components which have not been patched or upgraded or even supported any more that are open source.

That's the biggest source of vulnerabilities and the biggest opportunity in a bad way.

Hindustan Copper plans capital investment of over ₹7,000 cr over 5-6 years

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

State-owned Hindustan Copper Ltd (HCL) on Tuesday said it is planning capital investment of over ₹7,000 crore over the next five to six years, as part of an expansion drive that includes exploration, mine revivals and strategic partnerships.

In a regulatory filing, the company said it has taken several strategic initiatives in the copper and critical minerals segment, and has lined up capital investment of over ₹7,000 crore planned in the next 5-6 years.

The development assumes significance in the wake of the country's rising copper demand, driven by infrastructure expansion, renewable energy, electric mobility and other clean-energy applications.

The company, in a regulatory filing, said it has added 135.52 million tonnes of copper ore reserves and resources in the past three years, underlining a steady improvement in its resource base.

with CODELCO, Chile's state-owned copper company, aimed at capacity building, knowledge sharing and technical cooperation in mining, beneficiation and exploration.

Domestically, HCL has signed multiple memoranda of understanding with leading public sector undertakings like RITES, Indian Oil Corporation, Coal India, Oil India and GAIL, to expand its mining footprint and bolster India's mineral security.

MINING LEASES

The company is the sole vertically integrated producer of refined copper in the country, with capabilities spanning mining, ore beneficiation, smelting, refining and extrusion of copper rods. HCL holds all the operating mining leases for copper ore in India and controls access to about 45 per cent of the nation's copper ore reserves and resources.

Hindustan Copper's combined resources and reserves stand at 767.37 million tonnes.

COPPER DEPOSITS

HCL said it is actively pursuing the acquisition of new copper deposits both within India and overseas. A key focus of the plan is the reopening of closed mines across the country to ramp up domestic production, the firm added.

Hindustan Copper also announced a collaboration

thehindu **businessline.**
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Sd/- **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

MALANKARA PLANTATIONS LIMITED
(CIN: L66000KL1910PLC000650) Estd: 1910
Regd. Office: Malankara Buildings, Kodimatha (Post Box No. 72) Kottayam – 686013, Kerala, India. Tel:91-481-2568360, 91-481-2568335, E-mail: malankaraplantations@gmail.com, www.malankaraplantations.com

NOTICE OF 115th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND INFORMATION ON E-VOTING

Notice is hereby given that the **115th Annual General Meeting ("AGM")** of the members of Malankara Plantations Limited ("Company") will be held on **Friday, September 11, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (IST)** at the registered office of the Company to transact the business mentioned in the Notice.

The Notice of AGM along with the Annual Report for the FY 2025-26 has sent in electronic mode to the Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Depository Participant(s). A physical copy of the same shall be sent to those Members who specifically send a request at cs@malankaraplantations.co.in mentioning their Folio No./DP.ID. and client ID. Further, a letter providing the link, including the exact path, where the Notice of the AGM and the Annual Report for the FY 2025-26 is being sent to those members whose email address is not registered with the Company/RTA. Members who have not registered their e-mail address are requested to register the same with their respective depository participant(s).

Members may note that the Notice of the AGM along with Annual Report for the FY 2025-26 will also be available on the website of the Company at **www.malankaraplantations.com**, the website of the stock exchange (MSE) / **www.msei.in**. Members may refer to notes forming part of AGM Notice for the detailed instruction for remote e-voting. The facility for e-voting is arranged through Central Depository Services (India) Limited ("CDSL"). The **Record Date** for the said purpose has been fixed as **04th September, 2026**.

The remote E-voting period commences on **Tuesday, September 08, 2026 (9.00 a.m. IST)** and ends on **Thursday, September 10, 2026 (5.00 p.m. IST)**. E-voting shall not be allowed beyond 05.00 P.M. on **Thursday, September 10, 2026**. During this period, Members of the Company, holding shares either in physical form or dematerialized form, as on the cut-off date i.e. **Friday, September 04, 2026**, may cast their vote by remote E-voting. The remote E-voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently. The Company has appointed CS Panakkat Sandeep Kumar (M/s Panakkat Sandeep and Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries) to act as the Scrutinizer, to scrutinize the entire e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner.

In case any issue or queries regarding attending AGM & e-voting, you may refer the FAQ and e-voting manual available at **www.evotingindia.com**. under the help section or write an email to **helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com** or call **+91 9946102764**.

By order of the Board
For MALANKARA PLANTATIONS LIMITED
Sd/-
Place: Kottayam **BIBIN CHERIYAN**
Date: 19.08.2026 **Company Secretary & Compliance officer**

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Gold retreats as bond yields surge



Gold prices fell on Tuesday as Treasury yields surged to their highest levels in decades, with rising energy prices on escalating US-Iran tensions further stoking inflation worries. Spot gold had eased to \$4,363.14 per ounce by 1351 GMT. US gold futures for September delivery dropped to \$4,380.9. Silver slipped 1.5 per cent to \$64.82. **REUTERS**

Copper falls on LME stock build-up

Copper slipped as London Metal Exchange inventories climbed for a second day and the market digested weak economic data from top consumer China. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was down 0.8 per cent at \$14,036 a tonne as of 0900 GMT. Nearly 17,450 tonnes of copper flowed into LME warehouses on Monday. **REUTERS**

Crude oil swings near two-week high



Crude oil fluctuated near a two-week high, with the US and Iran stuck in a deadlock over control of the Strait of Hormuz. Brent traded near \$91 a barrel, after gaining 15 per cent since early August. US WTI crude futures were hovering near \$85. **BLOOMBERG**

Improving supplies may drag lithium prices lower in H2

PRICE FLOOR. However, energy storage demand is likely to hold rates from any sharp fall despite China ending tax sops on EV batteries

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Prices of lithium, a key raw material in electric vehicle (EV) batteries, are likely to head lower in the current half of this year due to a resurgence in supplies, but energy storage demand is likely to hold prices from any sharp fall, industry analysts have said.

Prices of lithium carbonate, a vital chemical compound used to produce EV batteries, dropped to a six-month low of 1,40,000 Chinese yuan (\$20,770), a tonne as risks of a drop in consumption combined with higher global supply. The prices have recovered by \$1,000 over the past week.

The *Trading Economics* website said prices had come under pressure also because China said it will end tax exemption for lithium-ion batteries to stop manufacturers from cutting prices to gain market share.

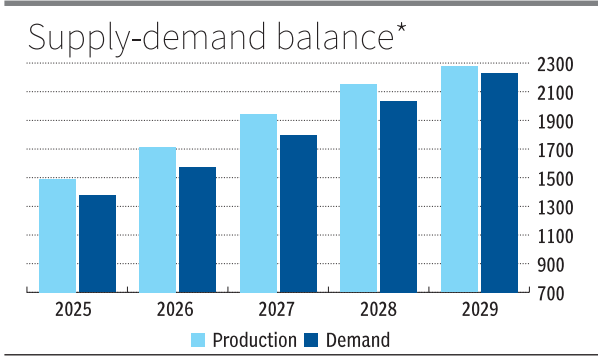
PRICE FORECAST
On Tuesday, lithium carbonate spot price ruled at 1,55,400 yuan (\$23,054), while benchmark futures ruled at 1,52,000 yuan (\$22,550).

“We are revising up our 2026 average annual lithium price forecasts to \$20,100/tonne for Chinese lithium carbonate 99.5 per cent and \$19,600/tonne for Chinese lithium hydroxide monohydrate 56.5 per cent as prices maintained solid up-

ward momentum throughout Q2 2026,” said research agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions. Lithium hydroxide monohydrate is another chemical compound used in EV battery production.

However, it expects lithium to drift lower this half, on imminent Chinese supply resurgence, alongside project restarts in Australia, which look to curtail the rally and serve as the primary bearish catalyst for the rest of the year.

SPODUMENE OUTLOOK
Australia’s Office of the Chief Economist (AOCE) said prices of spodumene concentrate, a high-purity lithium aluminium silicate powder produced by crushing and processing hard-rock



pegmatite ore, are forecast to stay elevated in 2026 around \$2,240 a tonne as refiners and cathode manufacturers continue to respond to solid demand from downstream industries.

“Lithium hydroxide prices are expected to follow a sim-

ilar path in the next few years, moderating from a 2026 high of about \$19,230 a tonne,” it said.

The AOCE said lithium prices had increased dramatically over the past 12 months, with spodumene concentrate increasing al-

most four-fold and lithium hydroxide almost tripling from mid-2025 lows.

“Spodumene concentrate average price to late May in the June 2026 quarter was around \$2,430 a tonne CIF (cost, insurance and freight) China. Lithium hydroxide prices averaged \$20,770 a tonne (free-on-board China) for the same period,” it said.

2 SUPPLY SHOCKS

Two notable supply shocks contributed to the rise in prices over the period. This includes China’s Jianxiawo mine’s permit lapsing in mid-2025, causing supply curbs to its battery mineral supply chains. It was exacerbated later by Jiangxi province revoking expired mining permits of the lepid-

olite mines in December 2025, said AOCE.

Chinese commodity data group Sunsir said the current lithium carbonate futures market is caught in a game between strong fundamentals and weak expectations. “The overall supply-demand pattern of domestic lithium carbonate still remains tight at present,” it said.

The AOCE said elevated global fuel costs associated with the West Asian conflict had prompted reports of faster EV uptake through the June quarter. “The extent to which this will spur a sustained shift in consumer preferences towards EVs remains a key upside risk to lithium demand over the outlook period,” it said.

Ensure smooth cotton buy, Telangana tells CCI

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

The Cotton Corporation of India (CCI) is gearing up for arrivals at designated procurement centres. Despite expectations of lower acreage due to the El Nino impact, the area under cultivation increased by nearly 1.21 lakh hectares in the State. The State government asked CCI to ensure a smooth procurement process and assured it of support.

Agriculture Minister Tummala Nageswara Rao also asked millers to open mills in the next 2-3 weeks to ensure they can accommodate the inflows.

Amid fears of a decline in acreage and production due to delayed and erratic rain in recent weeks, farmers in Telangana have planted 19.31 lakh hectares under kharif

crops this year, reaching the normal acreage for the season.

APP SNAG

Farmers, however, have flagged issues with slot booking on the designated app.

“When we were booking slots on the app run by the State government, we used to get slots at procurement centres mandal-wise. But now we are facing issues as they are allotting them district-wise,” Rambabu, a farmer from Khammam district, told *businessline*.

Farmers said reduced rainfall is proving to be a blessing in disguise as it has helped reduce the weed menace, he said.

Taking note of the complaints, the Minister asked the Centre to make the *Kisan Kapas* app more accommodating by incorporating the farmers’ suggestions.

East, North-East may see another rain spell on fresh ‘low’

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

Another round of heavy rain is likely across East and North-East India as the depression over Jharkhand and adjoining north Bengal moves west-northwest and weakens, while weather models point to a fresh low-pressure area forming before the month-end.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) placed the depression about 50 km east-southeast of Hazaribagh, 80 km north-east of Ranchi, 130 km south-east of Gaya, 180 km east of Daltonganj and 200 km south-east of Dehri on Tuesday.

LIKELY TO WEAKEN

The system is expected to track west-northwest across

Jharkhand and Bihar, weakening into a well-marked low-pressure area by Wednesday. Before it fades, however, it is likely to bring more heavy rain along its path and beyond.

Heavy to very heavy rain is forecast over parts of Assam and Meghalaya, West Bengal, Odisha, Jharkhand, Bihar, east and west Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Chhattisgarh.

The monsoon trough — the spine of the seasonal rain system — ran on Tuesday from Ferozepur through Dehradun, Shahjahanpur, Varanasi and Dehri, across the depression over Jharkhand and West Bengal, and on to Digha before dipping south-east into the north-east Bay of Bengal.

Cyclonic circulations over north Haryana and east Uttar Pradesh are adding fur-

ther weather fuel along its axis.

With the trough’s eastern end dipping into the Bay, the waters could spring back to life sooner rather than later, with another low-pressure area potentially taking shape. Its projected location suggests East and North-East India may continue to be the main beneficiaries of the resulting rain spell.

FRESH ‘LOW’ LIKELY

IMD’s numerical weather prediction models broadly support this scenario, pointing to the formation of a fresh ‘low’ before the month-end.

If it develops as indicated, East and North-East India could again find themselves in the wet zone, keeping the monsoon’s eastern flank active even as the current depression loses steam.



Union Agriculture Minister Shivrāj Singh Chouhan

been announcing it for quite some time before each session, the government did not list these Bills for daily ‘business’.

Earlier Chouhan administered a pledge to officials of the Agriculture and Rural Development Ministries un-

der the “Shakti ki Saptdhara” (Seven streams of empowerment) framework announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in his Independence Day address.

The seven-pronged framework, unveiled from the Red Fort, prioritises strengthening agriculture and food production, expanding food processing and improving farmers’ access to global markets.

LARGER CHALLENGE

Chouhan said that the roadmap for the two Ministries to achieve the government’s “Viksit Bharat” vision for 2047 had been discussed with stakeholders and will be finalised soon.

Sowing area under all kharif crops has reached 92 per cent of the season’s normal area of 1104.46 lakh hec-

tares (lh) while the deficit from the year-ago level has narrowed to less than 1 per cent until August 14 from 1.8 per cent until August 7.

The sowing area in the ongoing kharif season has reached 1,016.57 lh as of August 14, compared with 1,037.52 lh in the year-ago period.

On the other hand, the overall monsoon rainfall, which was 35 per cent (as per the revised data) deficient in June and 1 per cent surplus in July, has now shrunk to 13 per cent below normal during June 1-August 18. A total of 361 out of 741 districts have reported rainfall deficit of 20 per cent or higher, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) data show.

The rainfall during August 1-18 was 13 per cent below normal.

Moong arrivals pick up in Karnataka as prices rule firm on lower crop

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

The harvest of moong (green gram) has begun in Karnataka, with arrivals picking up in markets such as Gadag and Bagalkot.

However, trade sources said that the crop is likely to be lower this year due to a decline in acreage amid a delayed monsoon and deficient rainfall.

In Gadag, a major moong market in north Karnataka, arrivals were around 12,000 quintals on Tuesday, trade sources said.

“Prices have eased a tad compared with a few days ago as the arrivals seem better than expected. However, the moisture content in the new crop remains high at 18-21 per cent, against the government norm of 12 per



However, the moisture content in the new crop remains high at 18-21% against the government norm of 12%

cent. Demand is yet to pick up as traders and millers are reluctant to buy produce with high moisture, which could create storage issues.

The summer crop from Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat is available at lower prices,” a Gadag-based miller said.

Machine-harvested moong is fetching ₹7,000-8,500 per quintal on average, with the quality appearing dull due to the harvesting method and higher foreign-matter content. Hand-

picked moong, however, is commanding ₹8,600-10,300 per quintal, sources said.

DRYING HIT

The Centre has fixed the minimum support price (MSP) for moong at ₹8,780 per quintal.

Rain and cloudy weather are also hampering post-harvest drying in and around Gadag, posing a challenge for growers and processors.

Sources said the crop is lower this year due to re-

Supplyco cuts Sabari brand coconut oil price to ₹229/litre ahead of Onam

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

To cater to the increased demand during the Onam season, the Kerala State Civil Supplies Corporation (Supplyco) has reduced the price of its Sabari brand subsidised coconut oil to ₹229 per litre from ₹249 across outlets.

Official sources said the price reduction followed a ministerial decision and applies to a combination pack comprising subsidised and non-subsidised portions.

The price of the 500-ml subsidised portion has been reduced from ₹140 to ₹110. Consumers will have to produce a valid ration card to purchase the subsidised stock.

However, the Cochin Oil Merchants Association (COMA) said the price reduction is unlikely to cause



much concern among traders as Supplyco traditionally reduces prices during the festival season.

The move could, however, have an impact on domestic coconut oil consumption, given that retail prices are currently ruling around ₹300 a litre.

INCREASING SUPPLIES

The coconut oil market is currently steady, with wholesale prices ruling around ₹280 a litre.

Prices are expected to remain stable even after Onam, supported by the increased availability of copra, Thalathai Mahmood, President, COMA, said.

KK Devraj, a consultant to the coconut oil industry, said Supplyco’s intervention would help arrest the upward trend in prices.

Although Kerala witnessed good coconut harvest this season, traders from other States allegedly resorted to hoarding, creating an artificial price rise during Onam and pushing the retail prices above ₹300 a litre.

However, the move could put pressure on Kerala’s coconut oil millers, who are holding copra bought at higher prices, making their products costlier.

The government should also intensify checks against spurious coconut oil, Devraj said.

Indonesia’s planned comex to cover palm oil, nickel, coal

Reuters
Jakarta

Indonesia’s planned exchange for “mineral and strategic commodities” will likely include palm oil, nickel and coal, a presidential spokesperson said as the government makes preparations to launch the bourse on January 1.

KEY COMMODITIES

South-East Asia’s biggest economy is the world’s largest exporter of palm oil, thermal coal and nickel products and a major supplier of coffee beans, bauxite, tin and copper, among others. The government is currently ironing out the details on how to implement the plan, including the types of commodities that will be traded on the exchange.

Helm, Parijat Industries forge collaboration in agrochem space

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Germany-based chemical major Helm AG and Parijat Industries (India) Ltd, an agrochemical company with a multinational presence, have announced a collaboration spanning digital commerce, branded crop protection products, technical manufacturing and international distribution.

The collaboration will combine HELM’s agri-input portfolio and technology platforms, including its portfolio company Peat GmbH, developer of the Plantix digital agriculture platform, with Parijat’s manufacturing base, global distribution network and formulation capabilities, a media statement said.

As part of the collaboration, Parijat will acquire a re-

tailer-focused digital commerce platform and associated retailer database to improve procurement efficiency, market access and product distribution across key regions.

It will also work with the Plantix team to leverage its farmer network and demand-generation capabilities, including the exclusive integration of certain features for direct-to-farmer marketing.

The partnership will establish a new brand line in India, with Parijat and its subsidiary Leeds Lifesciences securing exclusive rights to use the Helm brand. Parijat plans to launch Helm’s ‘Plant Advantage’ range of biostimulants and biologicals in India.

MANUFACTURING

Internationally, the collaboration will leverage Parijat’s

manufacturing and patented formulation-development capabilities to meet Helm’s global requirements.

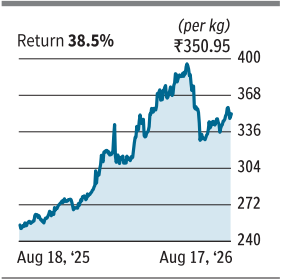
Parijat also plans to develop technical manufacturing capabilities for the proprietary molecules developed by Helm, with the companies intending to establish it as a toll-manufacturing partner for Helm’s global active-ingredient and formulation requirements. Uday Raj Anand, CEO, Domestic Business, Parijat Industries, said the partnership with Helm and Plantix was an important step towards Parijat’s vision of using digital technologies for farmer advisory and distribution in the agrochemical industry.

Helm AG CEO Stephan Schnabel said India was “a highly important market for the future of agriculture”.

COMMODITY CALL.

Aluminium futures: Buy on dips

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Aluminium futures (₹348/kg) have seen a drop in price over the past week. The chart hints at a further decline in price in the coming sessions before any recovery.

The August futures, after touching a high of ₹359.70 on August 11, have been on a decline.

Currently trading at ₹348, the contract has support ahead at ₹345, where both 21- and 50-day moving average exists.

The next support is around ₹342, where the contract is likely to meet a rising trendline.

We expect aluminium futures to resume the rally from either ₹345 or after extending the dip to ₹342. A potential upswing from either of these levels could lift the contract to ₹360.

A breakout of ₹360 could lift it to ₹370.

On the other hand, if the price drop leads to the breach of the rising trendline at ₹342, the outlook could turn bearish, where the contract could fall to ₹327.

That said, the inclination now is bullish, and aluminium futures could rally after the potential decline.

TRADE STRATEGY

Stay on the sidelines. Go long on aluminium futures if the price dips to ₹345. Place the stop-loss at ₹338.

When the contract rises to ₹355, revise the stop-loss to ₹348. Book profits at ₹359.

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BSE Stocks

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